

Articles for Reading



Book 1

30 Articles – B1 and B2 Level

Compiled by Mokhida Khakimova

CONTENTS:

1. IVORY
2. THE LOUVRE – FAMOUS MUSEUM IN PARIS
3. THE LEANING TOWER OF PISA
4. VISUAL ARTS
5. CLAUDE MONET
6. MONUMENTS AND MEMORIALS
7. MOSQUES
8. THE VATICAN MUSEUMS
9. IMPRESSIONISM
10. ANDY WARHOL
11. AMPHIBIANS
12. OIL
13. THE GIANT PANDA
14. VERTICAL FARMING
15. THE FOOD CHAIN
16. BANANAS
17. INSECTS
18. SUGAR
19. COFFEE
20. FISH
21. MUMMIES
22. JEANS
23. CHRISTMAS
24. THANKSGIVING
25. HALLOWEEN
26. EASTER
27. PASSOVER
28. CHINESE NEW YEAR
29. ITALIAN CITY BANS FOREIGN FOOD
30. BULLFIGHTING – A BIG ATTRACTION IN SPAIN

Articles in this book has been compiled by Mokhida Khakimova

Source: <http://www.english-practice.at>

IVORY

Ivory is a **smooth** material that can be found in the **tusks** of **mammals**.

Elephants, **walruses**, hippos and whales are the **primary sources** of ivory. Because it is so valuable and expensive, ivory has been traded around the world for **centuries**.

Egyptian **sculptors carved** ivory objects for their **pharaoh**. Ancient Greeks and Romans used ivory to create art, religious objects and **jewellery**. Even large statues were made of ivory. The **ancient** Chinese got ivory from traders that brought it from India and Southeast Asia. For centuries it was used as a **currency**.

At first people used ivory from Asian elephants but then saw that the ivory of African elephants was easier to carve. Traders started **moving in** on Africa and the ivory **trade** started to **boom**. Before plastic was **invented** ivory was used for making objects of everyday life, like knife **handles**, piano keys, combs and billiard balls.

The best known form of ivory is in an elephant's **tusks**. They can grow to a **length** of over 3 metres and **weigh** up to a hundred kilograms. The outside of a tusk is often dark, **whereas** the inside is white or cream-coloured. Ivory is a hard material that can be easily carved into different **shapes**. In many countries **handicrafts**, souvenirs and jewellery are made from ivory.

Ivory is also **preserved** in the **tundra** of Siberia, northern Canada and other polar regions where **prehistoric mammoths roamed** the continents thousands of years ago. Some of these tusks are larger than the tusks of mammals that exist today. However such **fossil** ivory is harder to carve.

Walrus tusks are **especially** popular in North America, where they were used by Native Americans for hundreds of years.

Today trading ivory from elephants and other **endangered** animals is **illegal**. During the 20th century large parts of the elephant population were **reduced** because of ivory trade. The poached ivory is **smuggled** out of the country and sold at a very high price.

Since the end of the 20th century **governments** of African and Asian countries have **focused on** capturing **poachers** and clamping down on illegal trading rings. Tons of ivory are **seized** by **authorities** every year. In the last few years these actions have **stabilized** the elephant population. Some countries have put elephants into **reserves**, where they can be closely **monitored**.

Words

- **ancient** = old
- **authorities** = organization within the government that has the power to make decisions
- **boom** = here: to become very successful
- **carve** = cut
- **century** = a hundred years
- **currency** = money that a country uses
- **endangered** = in danger
- **focus on** = concentrate on

- **fossil** = from an animal or plant that lived thousands of years ago and has been preserved in rock
- **government** = the people who rule a country
- **handicraft** = something that is made by a person using their hands
- **handle** = part of an object that you use for holding it
- **illegal** = against the law, not allowed
- **invent** = to create something for the first time
- **jewellery** = small things that you wear for decoration, like rings, necklaces, bracelets etc..
- **length** = how long something is
- **mammal** = animal that drinks milk from its mother when it is young
- **mammoth** = animal, like an elephant, that lived thousands of years ago
- **monitor** = watch
- **move in on** = here: go to a place in order to buy and sell things
- **pharaoh** = king in ancient Egypt
- **poacher** = someone who catches or shoots animals illegally
- **prehistoric** = a time before anything was written down
- **preserve** = to save something from being harmed or destroyed
- **primary** = main
- **reduce** = shrink; become less
- **reserve** = land where plants and animals are protected
- **roam** = wander around
- **sculptor** = someone who makes objects out of wood, stone, metal or other materials
- **seize** = when government officials legally take control of something
- **shape** = form
- **smooth** = flat, even
- **smuggle** = to take something illegally from one country to another
- **source** = where something comes from
- **stabilize** = here: to stay the same
- **trade** = buying and selling of products
- **tundra** = large flat areas of Russia, Canada and Scandinavia where it is very cold and there are no trees
- **tusk** = long curved and pointed teeth that stick out of the mouth of an animal
- **walrus** = sea animal with two long tusks that come down from the sides of its mouth
- **weigh** = how heavy something is
- **whereas** = while

THE LOUVRE – FAMOUS MUSEUM IN PARIS

The Louvre is one of the most famous museums in the world. **Situated** in the heart of Paris along the Seine River, it presents its visitors with an **impressive** collection of art from all over the world. Almost 10 million people visit the Louvre every year. The museum has over a million pieces of art, but at the moment only 35,000 are **on display**, **spread** over an area of 60 000 square metres.

The Louvre was built as a **fortress** in the 12th **century**. As time went on it **expanded**, as some parts were **rebuilt** and new **wings** added. In the 16th and 17th centuries, the Louvre **served** as the **royal palace** for French kings. It became an art museum when the French king Louis XVI moved his **residence** to Versailles. During the French Revolution, the Louvre became a **public museum**. New collections have been added **ever since**.

The museum offers collections **ranging** from early **Mesopotamia**, ancient Greece and Egypt, the Roman Empire down to the impressionists of the 19th century.

The most famous painting in the Louvre is Leonardo da Vinci's Mona Lisa. The Renaissance painting is **protected** by **bulletproof** glass and **flanked** by museum guards. Other popular works of art **include** the *Code of Hammurabi*, the *Venus of Milo* and *The Dying Slave* by Michelangelo.

IN the 1980s, the Louvre was completely **redesigned**. A gigantic **complex** was built under the courtyard. In front of the Louvre, there is a glass pyramid, through which people enter the museum. It is **in contrast to** the baroque architecture of the museum itself.

The Louvre consists of three separate wings that **span** four floors. It is so **huge** that you simply cannot see everything in a single day. The museum offers many **guided tours** ranging from **introductory** tours that show the museum's **masterpieces** to theme tours of a **specific** period of art.

Words

- **bullet-proof** = an object that is made to stop bullets from going in
- **century** = a hundred years
- **complex** = here: a series of rooms
- **ever since** = since then
- **expand** = to become bigger
- **flank** = on each side
- **fortress** = strong, large building used to defend a place from enemies
- **guided tour** = to show someone around a place and tell you the most important things about it
- **huge** = big
- **impressive** = if you admire something that is very large, beautiful or important
- **in contrast to** = compared to
- **include** = here: belong to the museum
- **introductory** = basic; here: it shows you the most important things
- **masterpiece** = the best pieces of art

- **Mesopotamia** = today's Iraq around the Rivers Euphrates and Tigris; in ancient times the first cities were built here
- **on display** = shown
- **protect** = guard
- **public museum** = museum which is open to everyone
- **range from ... to ...** = here: there are collections from all periods of history
- **rebuild** = build again
- **redesign** = to plan something new
- **residence** = home ; place where a person lives
- **royal palace** = place where the king or queen lives
- **serve** = to have a special function
- **situated** = located, where something is
- **span** = to go from one place to another
- **specific** = certain, special
- **spread** = lay out
- **wing** = part of a large building



THE LEANING TOWER OF PISA

Pisa, in the middle of **Tuscany**, is home of one of the most famous towers in the world. The Leaning Tower is **unique** because it has been **leaning** to one side since the Middle Ages. Apart from the Leaning Tower, Pisa's **cathedral square** also **includes** a **baptistery** and a church. Built to **symbolize** Tuscany's **wealth**, it **attracts** millions of visitors from around the world. In the past two **decades**, **efforts** have been made to **restore** the tower and save it from **collapsing**.

Construction work began in the 12th **century**. When the first three **storeys** of the eight-storey building were finished **engineers noticed** that the building did not **sink** into its 3-metre deep **foundation evenly**. The **soil underneath** the building was made up of soft **clay**.

Construction was **halted** for over a **century**. Workers tried to **strengthen** the foundation of the building by putting more **cement** into it. When construction was **resumed** construction workers tried to **compensate** the **slant** by building the upper storey taller on the side that was sinking in.

The 185 meter tall Leaning Tower of Pisa is made out of white **marble**. It weighs about 14 000 tons. Inside there are two **spiral staircases** that lead to the bell **chamber**. A total of seven bells, one for each note of the **musical scale**, were **completed** up to the beginning of the 16th century.

In the 1990s **authorities** closed the tower to visitors. It had reached an **angle** of 5 degrees. **Engineers** and **restoration** workers made efforts to **stabilize** the tower, which was sinking at 1.2 mm a year. In May 2001, the Leaning Tower of Pisa was **reopened** to the **public**. Since then the tower has been under **constant observation**. In 2008 tourism **authorities announced** that sinking had stopped and the tower was **expected** to be **stable** for the coming centuries. In 1989, the Leaning Tower of Pisa became a **World Heritage Site**.

Words

- **angle** = slant, bend
- **announce** = to say officially
- **attract** = pull towards, invite
- **authorities** = people who are in control of an area
- **baptistery** = building used to perform a ceremony in which water is poured on a person's head; this makes them a member of the Roman Catholic church
- **cathedral square** = place with a church or other religious buildings
- **cement** = grey powder, mixed with sand, stones and water to form a hard building material
- **century** = a hundred years
- **chamber** = room
- **clay** = heavy, muddy earth, used to make pots, bricks etc..
- **collapse** = break down

- **compensate** = make up for, balance
- **complete** = finish
- **constant observation** = watch carefully all the time
- **construction** = building
- **decade** = ten years
- **effort** = attempt, try
- **engineer** = person who plans, designs and builds houses, roads, bridges etc..
- **evenly** = equally, regularly
- **foundation** = basis; layer of cement and stones that is put under a building to support it
- **halt** = stop
- **include** = consist of
- **lean** = bend over
- **marble** = hard rock that becomes smooth when you polish it ; used for making buildings and floors
- **musical scale** = the musical notes between the first and the last
- **notice** = see for the first time
- **public** = all the people
- **reopen** = open up again
- **restoration** = repair
- **restore** = fix, repair
- **resume** = here: start building again
- **sink** = go down
- **slant** = angle, tilt
- **soil** = top layer of earth in which plants grow
- **spiral staircase** = stairs that move upwards in a circle
- **stabilize** = to become steady, so that it won't collapse
- **stable** = steady
- **storey** = floor, level
- **strengthen** = to make stronger, improve
- **symbolize** = be a symbol of, stand for something
- **Tuscany** = area of north central Italy, famous for its wine and old cities
- **underneath** = below
- **unique** = only one of its kind
- **wealth** = money, riches
- **World Heritage Site** = place or building , that is thought to be special and worth saving

VISUAL ARTS

Visual arts are forms of art that you can see, such as drawing, painting, **sculpture**, **printmaking**, photography and filmmaking. Design and working with **textiles** are also often **referred to** as visual art. Visual arts have changed over the **centuries**. During the Middle Ages artists **created** paintings, sculptures or prints and became famous. Today visual arts **applies** to many different forms.

Drawing

Drawing is creating a picture with a **variety** of **tools**, in most cases pencils, **crayons**, pens or markers. Artists draw on different types of **surfaces**, like paper or **canvas**. The first drawings were **discovered** in caves, that **date back** about 30,000 years.

Ancient Egyptians drew on **papyrus**, Greeks and Romans made drawings on other objects, like **vases**. In the Middle Ages drawings were **sketches** that were made on **parchment**. When paper became **common** in the Renaissance, drawing became an art **perfected** by Michelangelo, Leonardo Da Vinci and others.

Painting

Painting is often called the most important form of visual art. It is about putting colours on a canvas or a wall. Painters **express** their ideas through a **mixture** of colours and different **brush strokes**.

Painting is also one of the oldest forms of visual art. In old caves **prehistoric people** painted hunting scenes onto walls. Paintings became important in **ancient** Egypt, where **tombs** of **pharaohs** were covered with scenes of everyday Egyptian life.

During the Renaissance, painting became very important art. Italy became the center of Renaissance painting. The era produced masters like Michelangelo, Raphael and Titian. Italian **influence spread** to the north of Europe, mostly to Belgium and Holland. The most famous artists of the 17th century famous painters during the **Dutch Golden Age** were, Rembrandt and Vermeer.

During the last 200 years painters discovered new styles. Impressionism began in France during the end of the 19th century; Picasso created Cubism at the beginning of the 20th century.

Printmaking

Printmaking is art that is made by **covering** a **plate** with ink and pressing it on the **surface** of another object. Today prints are mostly produced on paper today but **originally**, they were pressed onto **cloth** or other objects. **Plates** are often made out of wood or metal.

The first prints were probably made in ancient **Mesopotamia**. Later on they became **popular** in ancient Egypt and China. Printmaking **spread to** Europe towards the end of the Middle Ages.

Photography

Photography is making pictures by letting light through the **lenses** of a camera onto a film. In **analogue** photography light was recorded onto a film, which had to be chemically **developed**. Images could then be printed onto special paper.

Today most photography is **digital**. Cameras have no film, the images are **recorded** onto **silicon chips**.

Filmmaking

Filmmakers make moving **images** that they turn into films. It is a very expensive and complicated form of art, **involving** many **tasks**, for example **scriptwriting**, **casting**, and **editing** film **sequences** before they can be shown to an audience. A full-length **feature film** often takes many weeks or months to produce.

Computer art

Today, art is no longer **limited** to **brushes**, paint and pencils. In the last few **decades** artists have been working with computers to **capture** images and change them. Computer art **consists** of a **wide variety** of different forms, from **capturing** and changing sound to creating video games.

Sculpture

Sculptures are three-dimensional **pieces** of art that are created by **shaping various** kinds of material. Among the most popular are stone, **steel**, plastic, **ceramics** and wood. Sculpture is often **referred to** as plastic arts.

Sculpture goes back to ancient Greece. It has been important in various religions of the world over many **centuries**. In the Renaissance Michelangelo was one of the **masters** of the art. His most famous piece of work was David, a **marble statue** of a naked man.

Words

- **analogue** = not digital ; for example an analogue clock uses pointers and not numbers
- **ancient** = old
- **apply to** = here: to be made up of
- **brush** = object that you use for painting
- **brush stroke** = a single movement of a pen or a brush when you are painting or drawing
- **canvas** = piece of cloth that an artist paints on
- **capture** = save
- **casting** = choose people who will act in a film
- **century** = a hundred years
- **cloth** = material used for making clothes
- **common** = popular, much used
- **consist** = made up of
- **cover** = here: put on
- **crayon** = stick of coloured wax or chalk that children use to draw
- **create** = make
- **date back** = go back to
- **decade** = ten years



- **develop** = here: make into paper prints
- **digital** = using a system of information which is stored in the form of numbers, usually ones and zeros
- **discover** = find for the first time
- **Dutch Golden Age** = time in the 17th century, in which the Netherlands was an important world power and produced many scientists and artists
- **editing** = put parts of a film together
- **express** = show
- **feature film** = full length film that usually has a story and uses professional actors; it is normally shown in a cinema and watched by millions of people
- **image** = picture
- **influence** = power, control
- **involve** = include
- **lens** = part of a camera through which light travels before it hits a film
- **limit** = exist only in a certain way
- **marble** = hard piece of rock that becomes smooth when you polish it; it is used for monuments, floors etc.
- **master** = a person who does things very well
- **Mesopotamia** = area in western Asia, around the Euphrates and Tigris River; important civilizations and cultures developed around this area and the first cities were built here
- **mixture** = combination
- **originally** = at first
- **papyrus** = paper made from a plant that grows in water
- **parchment** = material used in the past before paper came up; it was usually made out of the skin of goats or sheep
- **perfect** = to make something as good as possible
- **pharaoh** = ancient Egyptian king
- **piece** = object
- **plate** = thin piece of metal
- **prehistoric** = the time before anything was written down
- **printmaking** = creating pictures by putting ink on a plate and pressing it on paper, cloth etc..
- **record** = save
- **refer to** = call
- **scriptwriting** = write the storyline or plot of a film
- **sculpture** = object made out of stone, wood or other materials by an artist
- **sequence** = part of a film

- **shape** = form
- **silicon chip** = piece of metal that is used to save information
- **sketch** = simple, quick drawing that does not show much detail
- **spread** = move to other places
- **statue** = image of a person or animal made out of stone or metal
- **surface** = top part of an object
- **task** = job, thing to do
- **textile** = all types of cloth that are used for making clothes, tablecloth etc.
- **tomb** = place below the ground where a dead person is buried
- **tools** = here: objects you use to draw or paint
- **variety** = many different kinds of
- **various** = different
- **vase** = container used to put flowers in



CLAUDE MONET

Claude Monet was a French painter and one of the **leading** artists of the impressionist period. His paintings became famous around the world.

Monet was born in 1840 in Paris. His father had a **shipping** company while his mother **cared** for the family. At the age of five Monet and his family moved to Le Havre, where he went to school. His talent for drawing came out at an early age because the boy always liked to be outside.

In 1859 Monet went back to Paris to study art. There he met other artists of the time, **including** Renoir and Sisley. Together with them he started experimenting with painting in nature.

By the middle of the 1860s Monet was famous **throughout** the European art world. **However** his life started to change. He spent too much money and sank deeper into **debt**. In 1870 Claude Monet married his long-time **mistress** Camille, with whom he had a son, Jean. His wife died after becoming **seriously** ill in 1879.

In 1874 Monet and some of his **fellow** artists decided to show their paintings in an **exhibition**. **Critics** started to call them impressionists, named after Monet's painting "*Impression: Sunrise*". Many people visited the exhibition but the group did not sell any paintings.

In the 1880s and 90s Monet became famous in the United States and made money from selling paintings. In 1892 he married a second time. In his later life Monet travelled to London and Venice where he painted a **series** of **landscapes**. He died in 1926 in Giverny, France at the age of 86.

Monet's style of impressionism was all about nature. In his **works** he tried to **capture** nature as it appeared to him at the moment. He also experimented with light and **shadow** and how they changed during different times of the day. Some artists of the time criticised Monet and his style because they **lacked** detail and did **resemble** finished paintings.

Monet used strong colours, which he did not **mix**. He painted them onto the **canvas** in short brush **strokes**. He was also criticized for **abandoning** classical painting **techniques**.

In his later life he became fascinated with garden scenes. In Giverny he created a series of paintings called *Water Lilies*, **impressions** from a **pond** in his own garden.

Words

- **abandon** = leave , keep away from
- **canvas** = piece of cloth that an artist paints on
- **capture** = to show the feeling of a situation
- **care** = look after
- **critic** = someone who criticises a person or an idea
- **debt** = money that you have to give back to someone
- **exhibition** = show of art
- **fellow** = colleague



- **however** = but
- **impression** = feeling, thought
- **including** = also
- **lack** = not have enough of
- **landscape** = countryside
- **leading** = most important, top
- **mistress** = woman that you have a relationship with, even though she is married to someone else
- **mix** = combine, put together
- **pond** = small lake
- **resemble** = look like
- **series** = several, many
- **serious** = very much
- **shadow** = dark shape that a person or object makes when the sun shines on him or it
- **shipping** = here: to transport products by ship
- **stroke** = single movement with a pen or brush
- **technique** = method
- **throughout** = in all of
- **works** = collection of paintings



MONUMENTS AND MEMORIALS

Monuments are objects or buildings that have been **created** to **honor** an important person or a historic event that happened.

People have built monuments for thousands of years. In many cases they are symbols of **ancient** civilizations, like the pyramids of ancient Egypt or the Greek Parthenon. These monuments were so large that it took thousands of people to build them. During the past two hundred years monuments have become famous **landmarks** of cities. The Statue of Liberty in New York welcomed **immigrants** who came to the New World from Europe. The Eiffel Tower in Paris was built at the **entrance** of the 1889 **World Fair**.

Planned cities have often been built around man-made structures. The Washington Monument was built before the planning and **construction** of the city started. Brazil's new **capital** Brasilia was built around monumental structures.

Over history big structures have been built for many other **purposes**. The Great Wall of China is the largest man-made object on Earth. It was built to keep **invaders** out of China. Political monuments have been built **throughout** history to show the power of a country or its **society**. Statues of the Soviet Union's **founder**, Lenin, are found all over Moscow and other Russian cities. East Germany built the Berlin Wall to keep its **citizens** from **fleeing** to the West.

Columns have been used in history to build temples or hold the **weight** of **ceilings**. Some stand alone and have a statue of a famous person at the top, like Nelson's Column at Trafalgar Square in London. Many cities have **arches**, spanned over streets, which show success in wars and conflicts. Among the most famous is the Arc de Triomphe in Paris. Obelisks are four-sided pyramids that are very narrow and tall.

Memorials are built to **honor** dead people, often soldiers that have been killed in a war, like the Lincoln Memorial in Washington D.C. One of the most famous memorials is Mount Rushmore, in South Dakota. It is a **sculpture** of the faces of famous presidents, **carved** into a mountain.

One of the most **recently** built structures is the World Trade Centre Memorial at Ground Zero, which **commemorates** thousands of people who were killed during the 9/11 terrorist attacks.

Words

- **ancient** = very old
- **arch** = a structure with a curved top and straight sides
- **capital** = important city where the government of a country is
- **carve** = cut
- **ceiling** = the top part of a room
- **citizen** = a person who lives in a country or city and has rights there
- **column** = tall round stone used to keep up a ceiling
- **commemorate** = in honor of, to respect
- **construction** = building

- **create** = build, make
- **entrance** = door, opening, the way in
- **flee** = escape
- **founder** = a person who started something
- **honor** = admire, respect
- **immigrant** = a person who leaves their country and goes somewhere else to live and work
- **invade** = to move into a country with an army
- **landmark** = something that is easy to recognize, like a building or a mountain
- **purpose** = reason
- **recently** = a short time ago
- **sculpture** = object made by an artist out of wood, stone or other material
- **society** = the public, all the people
- **throughout** = in all of
- **world fair** = a very large show that shows buildings and the culture from different parts of the world.



MOSQUES

A mosque is a place where Muslims **worship** and pray to God. Some mosques are also places where Muslims get together and discuss things or where religious education takes place. In some countries mosques also **serve** political **purposes** and **imams** discuss political **issues**.

Mosques **date back** to the seventh century when they first **emerged** on the Arabian **Peninsula**. For **centuries** towns formed around this central building. Mosques have different sizes and shapes **depending on** which part of the world they are in. The most famous mosques are in Turkey and the Middle East. The best examples are the Blue Mosque in Istanbul, The Grand Mosque of Mecca or the Prophet's Mosque in Medina.

History

The model for building mosques was Mohammad's house in Medina, **constructed** in the 7th **century**. After his death mosques became important symbols of Islam. During the Middle Ages they were built wherever Arabs **settled**.

They spread quickly **throughout** northern Africa and southern Europe, as far as Spain. By the 15th century Islam had **spread** to Asia, where it became the **dominant** religion on the Indonesian islands of Java and Sumatra. During the **Ottoman Empire** Turks **converted** to Islam and many great mosques were built in Istanbul and other cities. With the Muslim **population** spreading to the Balkans mosques have become **widespread** in many cities and towns in Greece, Albania, Serbia and Bosnia.

Religious functions of a mosque

A mosque is **basically** a house of prayer but during history it has **acquired** many other religious functions. **Adult** Muslims must pray five times a day. While normal prayers can be said anywhere, Muslim men should pray in mosques on Fridays.

During the holy month of **Ramadan** other events take place in mosques. Some mosques offer dinners after sunset or breakfast before sunrise. During the last days of Ramadan some mosques hold all night prayers. Since Muslims are **required** to give money to **charity** they often **donate** it at mosques.

Political influence of a mosque

In the course of the 20th century mosques have served political **purposes**. As conflicts between western society and the Muslim world rose, mosques were used to **preach** peace and **understanding** among religions.

Mosques are often the center of **social conflicts**. In the past **decades** series of bombs have exploded in mosques all over the world. Al Qaeda and other terrorist organizations have **repeatedly** used mosques as a place to **recruit** and train radical Muslims.

In the 1960s Saudi Arabia started financing the construction of mosques around the world in an **attempt** to **spread** Islam. With **petrodollars** that the country has received in the last decades Saudis can afford **sharing** their **wealth** with others, **especially** poor Muslims.

Parts of a Mosque

Arab mosques usually have a square or **rectangular layout** with a **courtyard** in the middle. The first mosques had flat roofs on top of the prayer halls. Later on Islamic

architecture **focused** on **domes** and **arched entrances**. The Ottomans introduced mosques with a central dome over the prayer hall in the 15th century.

A **common** feature of many mosques is a minaret, a tall thin tower that is usually located at one of the corners. They were designed to make mosques as big as Christian churches, with their bell towers. From the minaret a muezzin **announces** praying time to **worshippers**.

The prayer hall normally does not have any **benches** or chairs. Worshippers pray in **rows** facing Mecca. There are no statues or pictures on the walls. Some mosques show verses of the Koran on the walls to **assist** worshippers. Many prayer halls have **columns** that uphold the roof. Every mosque has a mihrab, a **niche** in the wall that points to Mecca. From a **pulpit**, or minbar, the religious leader of the mosque, the imam **delivers** his speech.

In the course of time mosques became bigger and **attained** other functions. Today there are rooms for social **gatherings**, health clinics, **libraries** or **gymnasiums**.

Rules and How to Behave in a Mosque

There are many rules that **worshippers** must **obey** when they are in a mosque. In most mosques a religious leader, called **imam**, is in charge of praying, but in smaller mosques prayers may be said by **ordinary** Muslims.

Muslims must clean themselves before they enter a mosque. There are washing areas where they can wash their hands and face before entering the prayer hall. The floors of such a hall are normally covered with a **carpet**. It is not allowed to step on it with shoes.

Loud talking in a mosque is **forbidden**. It is also **disrespectful** to walk in front of Muslims who are praying.

Traditionally men and women are **separated** in mosques, **although** the Quran does not say anything about separation. Sometimes the women pray in rows behind the men, but more often they stay at home and pray.

Most mosques in bigger cities are open to tourists, but they too must **obey** the **strict rules**. You must wear clothes that do not **offend** Allah. Women are **required** to wear clothes that cover their body to their **ankles** and **wrist**. In some areas mosques are only open to Muslims.

Words

- **acquire** = get
- **adult** = grown-up person; not a child
- **although** = while
- **ankle** = moveable part between your foot and your leg
- **announce** = to say officially
- **arched entrance** = a large door with a curved top
- **assist** = help
- **attain** = get
- **attempt** = try

- **basically** = in general, normally
- **bench** = long seats for people to sit on
- **carpet** = woven material that covers floors
- **century** = a hundred years
- **charity** = organizations that help poor people
- **column** = tall stone , used to hold up the roof of a building
- **common** = popular, widespread
- **construct** = build
- **convert** = change to
- **courtyard** = open space in the middle of a large building
- **date back** = go back to
- **decade** = a period of ten years
- **deliver** = give
- **depend on** = based on
- **dome** = round roof on a building
- **dominant** = most important
- **donate** = give
- **emerge** = appear, can be seen
- **especially** = above all
- **focus** = concentrate on
- **gathering** = meeting
- **gymnasium** = special building or room where you can do physical exercise
- **imam** = a Muslim religious leader or priest
- **in the course of** = during
- **issue** = topic
- **library** = place where you can borrow books for a certain time
- **niche** = a small place in the wall where you can put something
- **obey** = follow
- **offend** = hurt
- **ordinary** = normal
- **Ottoman Empire** = large empire with its center in Turkey; it consisted of large parts of the Middle East, Northern Africa and the southeastern part of Europe; it started in the 13 th century and lasted until World War I
- **peninsula** = piece of land that has water on three sides
- **petrodollars** = money earned by selling oil
- **population** = the people who live in a country
- **pray** = to say words to god

- **preach** = to talk about a religious subject in a place where many people meet
- **pulpit** = raised structure in a church or mosque where the religious leader speaks to the people
- **purpose** = idea, function
- **Ramadan** = the ninth month of the Muslim year, during which Muslims do not eat or drink at day
- **recruit** = to find people who will work for someone
- **rectangular** = shape with four straight sides , two of which are longer than the other two
- **repeatedly** = over and over again
- **require** = have to
- **row** = line
- **rule** = law
- **separate** = divide, split up
- **serve** = to have a job or a task
- **settle** = to start living in a new place
- **share** = to use together with others
- **social conflicts** = problems that groups of people have with each other
- **spread** = move to
- **strict** = something that you must do
- **throughout** = in all of
- **traditionally** = things that have been done for a long time
- **understanding** = the way of knowing what other people do and want
- **wealth** = richness
- **widespread** = common, popular
- **worship** = to show respect and love for a god
- **wrist** = moveable part between your hand and your arm



THE VATICAN MUSEUMS

The Vatican in Rome is not only the **capital** of the Roman Catholic Church; it is also a place where **valuable** books, works of art and **sculptures** have been kept over many centuries. Four million people come to the Vatican Museums every year to **observe** these **precious masterpieces**.

As soon as you enter the Vatican Museums you walk through **sculptured** doors **created** by Cecco Bonanotte in 1999 to symbolize the Vatican's step into the new **millennium**.

Other works in the museum are thousands of years old. There are statues, **cloth textiles** and paintings that remind the visitor of **ancient** history. Not all the objects that the Vatican Museums **possess** can be seen. On some **occasions** the Vatican **lends** them to other museums for a certain time, or they may be **temporarily** taken out in order to be **restored**.

Observing all the Vatican's **artwork** would be a difficult **task**. Most visitors concentrate on the special points of interest. The following shows you the most important areas of the museum.

The Gallery of Maps **contains** a series of **topographical** maps of Italy. They **display** the world the way Italians saw it at the beginning of the Modern Age. The Gallery of **Tapestries** is full of wall hangings made of wool and **silk**. They tell picture stories from drawings that Raphael produced.

Roman Catholic leaders **founded** many of the Vatican Museums in the eighteenth and nineteenth **centuries**. Pope Gregory XVI created an Egyptian Museum with nine rooms of artworks, which were brought to Rome from Egypt. They show **pharaohs** who **ruled** ancient Egypt. One of the most **impressive** works is the Statue of Ramses II, sitting on a **throne**.

Another section of the Vatican Museums shows objects from ancient Etruscans, who lived in Central and Northern Italy. They produced objects of **baked clay**. The Etruscan Museum was **established** by Pope Gregory XVI in the 19th century. The collection also includes objects made of bronze and gold, as well as heads and statues of human bodies.

The Chiaramonti Museum is named after Pope Pius VII. It **contains** over a thousand works of art, **including** statues of Roman gods. The Pio-Clementino Museum, founded by Pope Clement XIV, is filled with ancient Roman and Greek sculptures. One of them shows a realistic scene of the war between Troy and Greece. **Based on** Virgil's poem Aeneid it shows a Trojan priest and his sons who are **crushed** by sea snakes.

Of all the art works that you can see in the Vatican Museums, experts agree that those of Raphael are probably the most beautiful. In the 16th century he was asked to paint the walls and **ceilings** of some of the Pope's private **living quarters**. One of his most famous works, a **fresco** called *The School of Athens*, shows famous Greek thinkers and scientists, who **gather** around Plato and Aristotle.

The Sistine **Chapel** is the private church of the Pope. It is the most famous room of the Vatican Museums, built in the 15th century. Besides being a special place where Cardinals get together to **elect** a new pope, the Sistine Chapel offers some of the most **spectacular** works of art. The **ceiling** is the most impressive part of the room, created by Michelangelo in 1508. He produced over fifty paintings with over 300 people in

them. The paintings show scenes from the Bible, **for instance** God creating the first man, Adam. It took Michelangelo over four years to finish the ceiling.

Some time later Pope Paul III asked Michelangelo to paint the walls of the chapel behind the altar. This famous painting became known as *The Last Judgment*. It shows Jesus Christ as the **judge** between good and evil. In it, some of the figures **rise** to heaven and others fall down to hell. Art critics are **undecided** about the **mood** this masterpiece puts you in. While some think of it as beautiful others say it is very frightening. **However**, all of them agree that it is one of the most famous works of art every created.

Words

- **ancient** = old
- **artwork** = paintings and other objects produced by an artist
- **baked clay** = sticky earth that you put into an oven to form objects
- **based on** = here: to come from, originate from
- **capital** = center
- **ceiling** = the top wall of a room
- **century** = a hundred years
- **chapel** = small church in a big church
- **cloth textiles** = works of art that are not painted but are made of cloth, silk and other materials
- **contain** = consist of
- **create** = make
- **crush** = to press something hard so that it breaks into pieces
- **establish** = make, create
- **for instance** = for example
- **found- founded** = create for the first time
- **fresco** = painting made on a wall while the plaster is still wet
- **gather** = stand around
- **however** = but
- **impressive** = something that you admire because it is very beautiful
- **including** = also
- **judge** = decide, give an opinion
- **lend** = give something to someone for a short period of time
- **living quarters** = place where you live
- **masterpiece** = work of art that is the best an artist has ever created
- **millennium** = the time when a new thousand year period begins
- **mood** = feeling

- **observe** = see
- **occasion** = event, time
- **pharaoh** = ruler of ancient Egypt
- **possess** = have, own
- **precious** = valuable
- **restore** = repair
- **rise** = move up
- **sculpture** = object made out of stone, wood, clay etc.. by an artist
- **sculptured** = cut or formed by hand
- **silk** = thin , smooth cloth made from fine thread that is produced by a silkworm
- **spectacular** = breathtaking , great, beautiful
- **tapestry** = large piece of cloth with pictures made out of thread; it hangs on the wall
- **task** = job
- **throne** = special chair used by a king or queen
- **topographical** = the shape of an area, its hills, valley, rivers ... etc
- **undecided** = not sure
- **valuable** = worth a lot of money



IMPRESSIONISM

Impressionism is an art style that **developed** in France in the late 19th **century**. Young painters used new **techniques** to paint outdoor scenes. They experimented a lot with different forms of light and color. Impressionists wanted to show the **viewer** how a **landscape** looked at different times of the day. They did not put so much **emphasis** on the detail of objects. Many critics of impressionism thought these artists were **sloppy** and did not care so much about their work.

Two of the most famous painters of this period were Claude Monet and Pierre-Auguste Renoir. Monet, for example, painted the same **scenic** pictures at different times of the day to show the viewers different **impressions**.

Before impressionism began painters **created** pictures of historical objects and followed **strict rules**. They liked to show things as **detailed** as possible. Starting in the 1860s painters tried something different. Edouard Manet **caused** a scandal by painting in **sketchy strokes**. He did not **concentrate** on the object but on the colors and light around it.

Many other artists followed Monet's style. They did not work in their studios any more but went outside and **observed** nature. They liked to work with natural light. But impressionists not only painted pictures of landscapes. They also drew paintings of factory buildings, railway trains and other things they saw around them.

Claude Monet's painting Impression: Sunrise in 1872 gave the style its name. Painters **adopted** this style as symbol of what they wanted to **achieve**: to give an impression of what they see.

The impressionists held a number of art shows in which they **displayed** their works. They created their most important **works** from 1870 to about 1910. This style **influenced** other artists of later generations, like Paul Gauguin and Vincent van Gogh.

Words

- **achieve** = get, reach
- **adopt** = take on, use, accept
- **cause** = lead to
- **century** = a hundred years
- **concentrate** = focus
- **create** = make
- **detailed** = complete, exact
- **develop** = here: come from
- **display** = show
- **emphasis** = importance, focus
- **impression** = feeling, thought
- **influence** = here: to affect the way other painters painted
- **landscape** = scenery, countryside

- **observe** = watch
- **rule** = instruction, law
- **scenic** = beautiful
- **sketchy** = unclear
- **sloppy** = careless, not exact
- **strict** = very exact
- **stroke** = movement of a pen or brush
- **technique** = method, way
- **viewer** = watcher, observer
- **works** = paintings



ANDY WARHOL

Andy Warhol was the most popular **figure** in the **pop art movement** that came up in the 1950s in the United States and Great Britain. During his career he produced paintings, films, **commercials**, print ads and other **works** of art. Andy Warhol's parents came to America from Czechoslovakia at the beginning of the 20th **century**. As a boy Andy liked to draw and cut up pictures. The family lived in Pittsburgh, where Warhol's father worked in a **coal mine**.

While in high school Warhol took art classes and drew **sketches** at the Carnegie Museum. He liked to go to the movies and started collecting fan articles of famous movies and stars. These objects **appeared** later on in Warhol's works. Warhol studied **art** in Pittsburgh and after moving to New York in 1949 he began work as an **illustrator** for magazines such as the New Yorker or Vogue. During this time he started using a special **technique** to draw **images** for ads. Andy Warhol became **unsatisfied** with this job and wanted to have his pictures shown in **art galleries**.

During the 1960s Andy Warhol concentrated on painting realistic pictures of everyday **items**. This style became known as pop art. Among his most famous paintings were **comic strips**, images of Marylyn Monroe, Muhammad Ali, Coca Cola bottles and the **electric chair**. His probably best known painting was the famous Campbell soup **can**. In his drawings Warhol **simplified** objects and portraits and painted them in many different colors. The center of Warhol's life was his art studio, called the Factory. There he met many other famous artists and **celebrities**. The Factory was also used as a film studio in which Andy Warhol produced many of his famous **underground** films. They usually had no special **plot** but were very long. In one of them he shows a man sleeping for five hours.

In 1968 a **frustrated** actress, Valerie Solanas, walked into Warhol's studio and shot the artist. **Although** he had already been **pronounced** dead, doctors managed to **reanimate** him and save his life. Warhol never **fully recovered** from this **incident**. During the 1970s and 80s Warhol continued to paint with the same **silk screen** technique that had made him **popular** but, in some way, his career was **declining**. In 1987 Warhol died at the age of 58 during a routine **gall bladder** operation.

Andy Warhol had a **unique** personality. He was a **declared homosexual** who liked to be famous and stand in the **spotlights**. He liked to be **surrounded** by **flashy** characters like Mick Jagger and Jim Morrison. The Andy Warhol Museum, in Pittsburgh is the largest art museum **dedicated** to one single artist. It holds more than 12,000 works of the **icon** of pop art. The highest-priced painting is Eight Elvises, images of Elvis Presley, which was sold for over 100 million dollars.

Words

- **although** = while
- **appear** = show
- **art** = painting and drawing pictures
- **art gallery** = building in which paintings and pictures are shown to the public
- **can** = metal container that has soup, food or something to drink in it
- **celebrity** = a famous person who is still alive

- **coal mine** = place where workers dig coal out of the earth
- **comic strip** = a series of pictures drawn inside boxes that tell a story
- **commercial** = advertisement on television or radio
- **declared** = something that is official or has been said in public
- **decline** = to go down
- **dedicated** = here: for only one person
- **electric chair** = chair used in the United States to execute criminals
- **figure** = person
- **flashy** = here: person who wears expensive clothes and likes to be famous
- **frustrated** = angry
- **fully** = completely
- **gall bladder** = organ in your body which stores a green material that your liver produces
- **homosexual** = to be sexually attracted to the same sex; gay
- **icon** = idol
- **illustrator** = someone who draws pictures for books and magazines
- **image** = picture
- **incident** = event
- **movement** = group of people who believe in or do the same things
- **pop art** = type of art that was popular in the 1950s and 60s; it showed everyday items as colorful paintings
- **popular** = liked; well – known
- **pronounce** = declare ; to say officially
- **reanimate** = here: to try to make a person's heart beat again
- **recover** = to become healthy again
- **silk screen** = drawing technique, in which ink is forced onto a surface through a piece of cloth
- **simplify** = to make simpler; without so much detail
- **sketch** = a simple drawing that does not show much detail
- **spotlight** = to get a lot of attention
- **surrounded** = here: he is in the company of many people
- **technique** = method of drawing
- **underground** = here: strange and sometimes shocking films that are only seen by a small number of people
- **unique** = single; there is nothing else like it
- **unsatisfied** = not happy
- **work** = here: painting

AMPHIBIANS

Amphibians are animals that live on land and in water. They were the **ancestors** of today's **reptiles** and **mammals** and the first **vertebrates** to **appear** on land, about 350 million years ago. Over 4000 types of amphibians live in almost all regions of the world, **especially** in hot and **humid** areas. Among the most **popular** amphibians are frogs and **salamanders**.

Physical features

Amphibians can grow to different **sizes**, smaller ones are only 1 cm in **length** and larger ones can **reach** up to one and a half metres. Those that live mostly on land **breathe** through their lungs, others, which live **mainly** in water have **gills**. An amphibian's skin is wet and often covered with a **sticky fluid** that **prevents** it from becoming dry. Some **species** lose their outer skin layer **several** times a year. Others produce **poison** that **protects** them from **enemies**.

Many amphibians are colourful animals that **blend in** with their **surroundings**.

Some amphibians, for example frogs have thick bodies and four powerful legs that they use to **leap** and swim. **Toads** have shorter legs than frogs and a drier skin. They have no tail.

Salamanders are amphibians with a short body and a long tail, which they can grow if they lose them. These **creatures**, which are found mostly in **temperate** climate zones, live near rivers and under rocks.

Caecilians look a lot like worms. They have long thin bodies without legs. These tropical amphibians are **nearly** blind because their eyes are covered with skin or bone. Only few of them live in water.

How amphibians live

Amphibians are cold blooded animals. Their body temperature is about the same as their **surroundings**. Most animals move to other places to **adjust** their body temperature if it gets too hot or too cold. **Depending on** the climate, amphibians **hibernate** or are inactive during the year when it gets too hot or cold. They eat many different kinds of food **including** insects and worms.

Life cycle

Most amphibians lay their eggs in the water. Young animals have fish-like **features**. After living as a **larva** they grow **gills** which allow them to breathe under water. During a phase called **metamorphosis** a young amphibian **develops** from a larva into an adult. This stage can take from a few weeks to several years. Some amphibians then lose their gills and develop lungs for breathing. Often they also change their **appearance**.

Words

- **adjust** = get used to, change
- **ancestor** = here: animal that lived in the past and from which modern animals have grown
- **appear** = show up, come to
- **appearance** = the way something looks
- **blend in** = you do not notice something



- **breathe** = take air into your lungs
- **caecilians** = group of amphibians
- **creature** = living thing
- **depend on** = to be directly affected by something
- **develop** = grow
- **especially** = above all
- **feature** = element
- **fluid** = liquid
- **gill** = organ inside a fish that allows it to breathe
- **hibernate** = sleep during the winter
- **humid** = wet
- **including** = also
- **larva** = here: the first phase of an amphibian
- **leap** = jump
- **length** = how long something is
- **mainly** = mostly
- **mammal** = it drinks milk from its mother when it is young, human, dogs or whales, for example, are mammals
- **metamorphosis** = to change completely
- **nearly** = almost
- **poison** = substance that is dangerous and can kill you
- **prevent** = stop
- **protect** = defend
- **reach** = here: get to a certain size
- **reptile** = animal whose body temperature changes according to the temperature around it; it usually lays eggs to have babies
- **salamander** = small animal, like a lizard, that can live on land and water
- **several** = many
- **size** = how big something is
- **species** = group of animals that look alike and can produce young animals or plants together
- **sticky** = something that sticks to the surface of an object
- **surroundings** = the world around you
- **temperate** = not too hot and not too cold
- **toad** = animal that looks like a frog
- **vertebrate** = living creature that has a backbone

OIL

Petroleum or oil is a thick, yellow to black **liquid** found in rock **layers**. It is made up of **organic** material, formed millions of years ago from dead plants and animals. Deep in the ground **pressure** and heat transformed them into oil. **Crude oil** is oil in its natural **state**. Many other products are made out of petroleum. Every day our planet **consumes** about 90 million **barrels** of oil. Because oil needs millions of years to **develop** we will run out of the energy, which we so much **depend** on.

History of oil

Oil has been used in one form or another over thousands of years but it has become really important to our **economy** in the last 2 **centuries**. It has been the most important **source of energy** since the end of World War II.

The first oil **well** was created in the middle of the 19th century in Pennsylvania. By 1870 oil production had **spread** to other American states. During the **latter** part of the 19th century oil was also produced in Canada and in European countries.

The automobile **boom** of the early 20th century led to a higher **demand** of oil. It played an important **role** as the main **fuel** for tanks and planes in the two world wars.

By 1950 the United States had become the world's largest oil producer. In the second part of the 20th century Saudi Arabia and Russia produced even more than the USA.

Today more than 90 percent of all **vehicles** are **powered** by oil products. It is the most important source of energy in our world. About 80% of the world's oil **reserves** are located in the Middle East. Other **notable** producers are Venezuela, Great Britain and Indonesia.

What petroleum is made out of

Crude oil consists mainly of **hydrocarbons**, a combination of **hydrogen** and **carbon**. Each **deposit** of petroleum has a different combination of hydrocarbons, **thus** making it a thicker or thinner liquid. It also has **sulphur**, **nitrogen** and other elements in it.

How oil is produced

Before oil can be **extracted** from the earth **geologists** first must **examine** the land and the rock layers that lie **underneath** the **surface**. Up to about 30 years ago **drilling** for oil was a great risk. Geologists could not **guarantee** that oil would be found where they **presumed**. Today modern **exploration** methods make it possible to find oil with a 70% **success** rate.

Most of the world's oil is produced by drilling into the **crust** of the earth. Crude oil is found together with gas, which **floats** above the oil layer. Sometimes gas is **extracted** together with oil during the drilling process, at other times it is simply **burned off** when it comes to the surface.

Before oil can be brought to the surface a **drilling rig** is set up. Oil is often **buried** deep down in rock layers, so that drills must go down to a depth of 10000 meters and more. **Offshore** rigs operate on **platforms** in the ocean. They drill for oil **underneath** the ocean floor.

After it is brought up to the surface crude oil is brought to **refineries**, where it is made into petrol or gas, heating oil, **kerosene**, fuel for airplanes and plastic products.

Other **chemicals** and **fertilizers** are also made out of crude oil.

Not all oil is found in rock below the **surface**. Some lies **trapped** in oil sands, but production is still expensive.

Petroleum industry

The oil industry **combines** many different **tasks**. **In addition** to exploring new reserves, drilling and refining oil, the industry must also bring oil products to the **consumer**. **Giant** supertankers transport crude oil across the oceans all over the world. Pipelines bring oil over land from one part of a continent to another.

Price of oil

The price of oil changes **constantly, depending on** how much is produced and consumed. Many factors can **influence** the price of oil. **Especially** wars and conflicts in oil-producing countries can lead to a **rise** in oil prices. The energy crisis of the 1970s, for example, led to a dramatic **rise** in oil prices and threw the world's **economy** into a deep **recession**. The Organization of Petroleum Exporting Countries (OPEC) has had a great influence on production and the price of oil since the 1970s.

Oil consumption

Most of the world's oil is needed in the western world. The United States is the world's largest oil **consumer**. It uses up about a **fifth** of the daily oil production. Japan, the European Union and China are other **major** consumers of oil.

Environmental effects of oil production

Producing and consuming oil and oil products **affects** our **environment** in many ways.

It is a **major cause** of global warming because burning **fuel releases carbon dioxide, thus** causing the **greenhouse effect**. Oil drilling is often damaging to the environment because **chemicals** are used to **separate** oil from water.

In the past **decades** there have been a **series** of tanker accidents that have **polluted** the world's oceans and seas. The biggest **disaster** was the sinking of the Exxon Valdez off the coast of Alaska in 1989. In 2010 an **oil spill** in the Gulf of Mexico spread to coastal areas in the USA and Mexico and **polluted** thousands of square kilometers of water.

Words

- **affect** = to have an effect on, change
- **barrel** = unit of measurement for oil = 159 liters
- **boom** = time when something is very popular
- **burn off** = burn without being used as energy
- **bury** = here: covered by other rocks
- **carbon** = chemical that exists in its pure form as diamonds; it is in coal and oil
- **carbon dioxide** = gas that is produced when animals or people breathe out
- **cause** = reason for

- **chemical** = material produced in a chemical process
- **combine** = bring together
- **constantly** = all the time
- **consume** = use, burn
- **consumer** = person who buys or uses a product
- **crude oil** = oil in its natural condition, the form in which it comes out of the earth
- **crust** = hard outer layer of the earth
- **decade** = ten years
- **demand** = need
- **depend on** = need
- **deposit** = layer
- **disaster** = catastrophe; when something very bad happens
- **drill** = make a hole into an object
- **drilling rig** = large structure on land or in the sea which has the machines for getting oil from under the ground
- **economy** = the system by which a country's goods and money are produced and used
- **environment** = the world around us
- **especially** = above all
- **examine** = look at very closely
- **exploration** = the process of looking for something , like oil or gold
- **extract** = take out, remove
- **fertilizer** = substance that you put into the ground in order to make plants grow better
- **fifth** = 20 percent
- **float** = move without sinking
- **fuel** = material we use to produce energy - like coal, oil or gas
- **geologist** = person who studies rocks and the way they have changed since the earth was formed
- **giant** = very big
- **greenhouse effect** = the warming of the atmosphere; when light gets in and heat cannot get out
- **guarantee** = promise
- **hydrocarbon** = chemical compound that consists of hydrogen and carbon
- **hydrogen** = colorless gas that forms water when put together with oxygen
- **in addition** = also
- **influence** = change, have an effect on
- **kerosene** = clear oil that is burnt to provide heat or light
- **latter** = second

- **layer** = material between two other objects or material
- **liquid** = fluid, watery material
- **major** = important
- **nitrogen** = gas that has no color and smell; it forms most of the earth's atmosphere
- **notable** = important
- **offshore** = in or under the sea, not far from the coast
- **oil spill** = when oil leaks out into the ocean
- **organic** = living things
- **platform** = structure with machines and rooms on it
- **pollute** = to make dirty
- **power** = run
- **pressure** = force, power, weight
- **presume** = think, believe
- **recession** = difficult time in the economy, when there is less trade and people do not buy so much; they also have fewer jobs
- **refinery** = factory where crude oil is separated into its single elements and where other products are made out of oil
- **release** = set free
- **reserves** = here: oil that has not yet been discovered but probably lies deep under the surface
- **rise** = if something goes up
- **role** = part, function
- **separate** = split, divide
- **series** = a few
- **source of energy** = here: where energy comes from
- **spread** = extend, stretch, open out to
- **state** = condition, shape, form
- **success** = here: victory, win
- **sulphur** = light yellow chemical that burns and has a very strong, unpleasant smell
- **surface** = top part of something
- **task** = job
- **thus** = that is why
- **trap** = caught in a place and unable to escape
- **underneath** = below
- **vehicle** = machine that has a motor and can take people from one place to another, like a car, bus or truck
- **well** = deep hole in the ground

THE GIANT PANDA

The giant panda is a bear that lives in central China. It is special because of its black and white **fur**. Pandas belong to the most **endangered species** of our world. About 2000 pandas live in the **wilderness**, 300 live in **various** zoos around the world.

Recently, there have been **campaigns** in many countries to save the giant panda. It has been **driven away** from its natural **habitat** because of **deforestation**, intensive farming and the **creation** of new **settlements**.

The giant panda can reach a **height** of up to 1.5 metres and **weigh** up to 150 kg. Pandas have bodies like bears, but **scientists** do not know why they grow a black and white fur. The thick fur keeps them warm during the cold winter months and the white colour **protects** them from possible **enemies** in the snow-covered mountains in which they live. Pandas have large teeth, which they need to eat **bamboo**, their **basic** food. The animals can eat up to 15 kg of bamboo a day. Because it is low in **nutritional value** it does not give pandas much energy to move around for longer periods of time. They spend most of the day **roaming** around and looking for food and water.

Giant pandas can live up to 20 years in the wilderness and 30 years in zoos. They start **reproducing** between 4 and 8 years of age. Mothers carry their babies in their bodies for a **period** of 3 to 5 months. When panda **cubs** are born they are blind. They are extremely **tiny**, only about a thousandth the **size** of the mother. Like all **mammals**, they get their food from their mother, whom they stay with for one and a half to three years before being able to **survive** alone.

Pandas have a low **birth rate**. When a female gives birth to two pandas, only one normally **survives**. In her **lifetime**, a female may give birth to 5 to 8 cubs a year. They are in danger of dying out **completely** because their living space is becoming smaller. Giant pandas have been hunted for **centuries**, **mainly** because of their soft fur.

Pandas have been an important **species throughout** history. They first became known in the western world during the middle of the 19th century. In the 1960s, the Chinese **government realized** it had to do something to protect the giant pandas. Since then they have set up 40 **reserves** in which the animals are protected. In the 1970s, pandas played a part in the **opening** of Communist China to the west. They were sold to zoos in other countries.

Today, about 45 pandas live in zoos outside China. The first one arrived in New York in 1937. **Zoologists** are putting millions of dollars into **breeding** the animals in **captivity**. When they get older they may be **released** again into their natural habitat.

Words

- **bamboo** = a tall tropical plant that is hollow inside
- **basic** = necessary
- **birth rate** = the number of babies based on the whole population
- **breed** = to keep animals in order to produce new ones with special qualities
- **campaign** = movement, actions that are carried out by people
- **captivity** = here: kept in a cage

- **completely** = totally
- **creation** = make something new
- **cub** = baby animal
- **deforestation** = cut or burn down trees in an area
- **drive away** = here: to make them leave
- **endangered species** = group of animals or plants that are in danger of dying out completely
- **enemy** = not your friend; here: animals that want to hurt them
- **fur** = the thick soft hair of an animal
- **government** = people who rule a country
- **habitat** = living area
- **height** = how high something is
- **lifetime** = during your whole life
- **mainly** = mostly
- **mammal** = type of animal that drinks milk from its mother's body when it is small
- **nutritional value** = substances in the food that help you stay healthy
- **opening** = the beginning of ...
- **period** = time
- **protect** = defend, guard, to keep safe from
- **realize** = understand
- **recently** = a short time ago
- **release** = set free
- **reproduce** = to have babies
- **reserve** = an area of land where plants and animals are protected
- **roam** = wander around
- **scientist** = a person who is trained in science and works in a laboratory
- **settlement** = place where people build new houses and start to live
- **size** = how big something is
- **species** = group of animals or plants that are alike
- **survive** = to stay alive
- **throughout** = all of
- **tiny** = very small
- **various** = different
- **weigh** = how heavy something is
- **wilderness** = area of land that has never been developed or farmed
- **zoologist** = scientist who studies animals and the way they behave

VERTICAL FARMING

Vertical farming is the method of growing plants and **crops** over each other, mostly in buildings with many **storeys**. They often look like **skyscrapers** with glass around them, **similar** to a giant **greenhouse**. Such farming methods can already be seen in cities. For **agriculture** experts vertical farming will be in **widespread use** in the future because the world's population is growing **constantly** and there is more need for farming land.

The idea comes from Dickson Despommier, a professor at Columbia University, who in 1999, **developed** a method of growing food in city skyscrapers that could be as tall as thirty storeys. Today, such projects are carried out in many countries, for example Korea, Japan, Abu Dhabi and Singapore.

Vertical farming offers many **advantages**. **Crops** can be grown on a smaller area of land, water can be **recycled** and used over and over again. Plants grow on minerals and do not need **soil**. Many farming products can be **harvested** more than once per year. With some fruits, like strawberries, up to 30 harvests would be possible.

This new form of farming can also help nature and the **environment** recover from mistakes humans make when farming. Many **resources** could be saved, forests could be **preserved** and **desertification limited**. Burning less **fossil fuels** would **result in** fewer emissions, a **reduction** of global warming and healthier **environments**. **Especially** tropical regions with their high risk of getting **diseases** like malaria would **benefit**.

Vertical farming can **protect** crops from bad weather or **disasters** like hurricanes, storms, **droughts** or floods. The same weather conditions all year round **provide** ideal conditions for perfect crops.

With **traditional** farming, 30% of all food does not find its way to the **consumer**, either because it becomes **spoilt** during transport or is **infested** with **bacteria**. Vertical farming produces food where it is needed.

On the other side, building such vertical farms can prove to be a **costly undertaking**. During the beginning of such a project a lot of energy is needed. Because plants **require** large **amounts** of sunlight buildings need to be **provided** with **artificial** sunlight the whole year. But **compared** to traditional farms that take up a lot of space vertical farming has a low **carbon footprint**. It can do without fossil fuels because it **relies** on energy from the sun. **Overall** transportation costs are lower because products are **consumed** in the cities in which they are produced. This could be extremely **cost effective** because trends show that more and more people are moving to cities. By the middle of the 21st **century** about 80% of the world's population will be living in **urban** areas.

Critics are not sure **whether** vertical farming projects can really be **profitable** in the **long term**. They **claim** that **initial** costs are too high and **suggest** that such farms **actually** need more light and power than in normal regions. Heating and cooling costs would also be **enormous**.

They also say that not all crops can be grown in this way. **Wheat** and **maize**, for example, among the world's most important **food source**, would be almost impossible to grow because they are too large and heavy. Such farming methods could only **apply** for **lightweight produce**, like small fruits, **lettuce** and other vegetables.

Words

- **actually** = really
- **advantage** = the good side of something
- **agriculture** = farming
- **amount** = sum
- **apply** = work with
- **artificial** = made by man
- **bacteria** = very small living things, some of which cause illnesses
- **benefit** = help, do good to something
- **carbon footprint** = the total amount of greenhouse gases that you produce in a certain time
- **century** = a period of a hundred years
- **claim** = to say that something is true
- **compare to** = if you look at two things side by side
- **constantly** = always , all the time
- **consume** = use
- **consumer** = a person who buys things in a store
- **cost effective** = here: cheap
- **costly undertaking** = here: a project that needs a lot of money
- **critic** = person who is very sceptical about a topic
- **crop** = a plant, such as wheat or rice, which is grown by farmers and used as food
- **desertification** = the process in which farming land is changed into deserts
- **develop** = create
- **disaster** = a sudden event, like a flood or an earthquake, which can cause great damage
- **disease** = illness
- **drought** = long period of dry weather, when there is not enough water for plants and animals to live
- **enormous** = very large
- **environment** = the world around us
- **especially** = above all
- **food source** = place where food comes from
- **fossil fuel** = coal, oil, wood or gas; forms of energy that have been produced over millions of years from dead plants and animals
- **greenhouse** = glass building used for growing plants; light gets in and is turned into heat
- **harvest** = to gather crops from the field
- **infest** = fill with

- **initial** = at the beginning
- **lettuce** = round vegetable with green leaves that are eaten raw in salads
- **lightweight** = not heavy
- **limit** = control
- **long term** = not soon, but in the course of a longer time period
- **maize** = corn; tall plant with yellow seeds on a cob; it can be cooked or eaten as a vegetable
- **overall** = general, complete
- **preserve** = conserve, keep
- **produce** = food types, crops
- **profitable** = money-making
- **protect** = guard , care for
- **provide** = offer, give
- **recycle** = to use again
- **reduction** = something becomes less; to lower
- **rely** = depend on
- **require** = need
- **resource** = something that is useful to us , like minerals or water, which exist in a country and can be used to make it richer
- **result in** = lead to
- **similar** = like
- **skyscraper** = very tall modern building in a city
- **soil** = top layer of earth on which plants grow
- **spoil-spoilt** = here: food becomes bad, so that you cannot eat it any more
- **storey** = floor or level of a building
- **suggest** = advise, recommend
- **traditional** = old fashioned , normal, usual
- **urban** = city
- **wheat** = plant that white bread is made from
- **whether** = if
- **widespread use** = here: used very much



THE FOOD CHAIN

The food chain is the order in which animals and plants eat each other in order to **survive**. Every living **creature** needs to eat other creatures below it. Every **ecosystem** has a different food chain, **depending on** which animals and plants live there.

The lowest part of the food chain are the plants. They are called producers because they produce their own food using the sunlight's energy. This process is called **photosynthesis**. Animals are the **consumers** of the food chain. They eat other plants and animals.

Some animals only eat plants. Among this group of **herbivores** are rabbits, mice and cows. **Carnivores** are animals that eat other animals, like wolves, foxes or lions. Each food chain has a **predator**, the strongest animal that is not eaten by others. **Hawks** or polar bears are such predators that **dominate** their **habitats**.

Many creatures belong to more than one food chain. Grass, for example, is eaten by many other animals as well as insects. Food chains that are **connected** to each other are called food webs.

When an animal dies it is eaten up by worms, **bacteria** and other **organisms**. These so-called **decomposers** break down animals and plants into small parts and **enrich soil** so that other plants can grow better. The **nutrients** of dead animals and plants are **converted** back to the soil so that plants can use them again.

The **balance** of plants and animals within a food chain is **determined** by nature. For example, if there are too many zebras in a tropical habitat many of them will die because they cannot get enough food to feed on. This also means that there is less food for predators, like lions, to eat. And when there are fewer lions the zebra population will grow again.

Words

- **bacteria** = very small living things, some of which cause illness and disease
- **balance** = equal amounts of something
- **carnivore** = animal that eat the meat of other animals
- **connect** = link
- **consumer** = user
- **convert** = change
- **creature** = something living
- **decompose** = to break down into many very small parts
- **depend on** = affected by other things
- **determine** = decide
- **dominate** = control
- **ecosystem** = animal and plants that live in a certain area and how they exist in their environment
- **enrich** = to make better
- **habitat** = living area

- **hawk** = large bird that hunts and eats other, smaller birds
- **herbivore** = animal that only eats plants
- **nutrient** = chemical or food that gives plants and animals what they need to grow
- **organism** = animal, plant, person or any other living thing
- **photosynthesis** = when green plants turn sunlight into energy
- **predator** = animal that kills and eats all other animals in a region
- **soil** = the top layer of earth; on which plants can grow
- **survive** = to live on



BANANAS

Bananas belong to the most **popular** and most eaten fruits in the world. They were first grown in tropical India and Southeast Asia over 4000 years ago. Arab **merchants** brought them to northern Africa and the Middle East.

Portuguese **navigators discovered** bananas when they sailed down the Atlantic coast of Africa. From there they were brought to the Canary Islands, from where Spaniards took them to the New World.

Physical Features of a Banana Plant

Although bananas grow like trees they are **actually** plants. They are made up of **stalks** that are covered with **overlapping** leaves. A stalk or **stem** can be about 30 cm thick. A banana plant can grow up to 6 meters in **height**. It has up to 20 long and wide leaves.

Bananas hang in **clusters**, also called hands, from the plant. Each cluster can carry about 10 to 20 bananas.

Bananas need good, **well-drained soils**, as well as a warm tropical climate with enough rainfall to grow. They are often **cultivated** on **plantations**, often with hundreds of workers who **cultivate** and **harvest** bananas for the world market. These large farms sell their products to large companies like, Chiquita and Dole.

The first banana fruits can grow about a year after planting. Bananas are **endangered** by temperatures below zero and strong winds. **Diseases**, like the Panama disease, an **infection** of the soil, can completely destroy banana **crops**.

Harvest

Bananas are harvested while they are still green. In this **state** the banana's **flesh** is white and cannot be eaten. The green fruits are taken to the nearest port, where they are put on container ships with **cooling** containers on board.

When the bananas arrive at their **destination** they are **loaded** onto trucks or railway cars and brought to sellers who **store** them in special **ripening** rooms. From this time on it takes bananas about five days to **ripen** and get the yellow colour and taste we all know. As the fruit ripens the **flesh** also becomes sweet.

Banana as a staple diet

In many tropical regions of Africa, South America and Asia, bananas are a main food for the population. They have many **nutrients** that people need. **In addition** to 75 % water, a banana contains sugar, **proteins** and vitamins. It gives you quick energy and can be **digested** fairly easily.

Bananas belong to the healthiest foods in the world. They contain **potassium**, which can lower your **blood pressure**, **prevent** heart diseases and **reduce** the risk of a **stroke**. In the western world bananas are eaten as snacks **in-between** meals or together with **cereals**. In other countries they are used to make wine or beer.

Types of bananas

There are up to a thousand different kinds of bananas. The Cavendish banana is the most widely produced and eaten fruit in the world. Bananas that are used for cooking are called plantains.

Economic Value

Bananas are the fourth most **valuable** food crop in the world, after **wheat**, rice and corn. They are important for the **economy** of tropical countries. About 140 million tons are harvested **annually**, however only a small percentage of the **actual** production is exported. The biggest banana-producing countries in the world actually need most of the fruit themselves.

India is the world's largest banana producer, followed by Uganda, China, the Philippines, Ecuador and Brazil.

Banana Trade

Today the banana **trade** is a 5 **billion** dollar industry. Large companies like Chiquita and Dole control most of the banana exporting industry. **Especially** in Central America and the **Caribbean** workers suffer from poor working conditions and get **low wages**. For **decades** EU countries preferred bananas from their **former** colonies in Africa and the Caribbean and placed **taxes** on imported South American bananas. In 2009 this long trade war came to an end.

Words

- **actually** = really
- **although** = while
- **annually** = every year
- **billion** = a thousand million
- **blood pressure** = the power with which blood flows through your body
- **Caribbean** = area between the Gulf Coast of North America and South America
- **cereal** = breakfast food made from grain and usually eaten with milk
- **cluster** = here: group of fruits
- **cool** = to make colder
- **crop** = here: the plants on a field
- **cultivate** = grow
- **decade** = a period of ten years
- **destination** = end of a journey or trip
- **digest** = change food that you have eaten into substances that your body can use
- **discover** = find something for the first time
- **disease** = illness
- **economy** = the system by which the money and goods of a country are produced
- **endanger** = threaten
- **especially** = above all
- **flesh** = soft part of a fruit and vegetable that can be eaten
- **former** = earlier
- **harvest** = gather ripe crops from the field



- **height** = how high something is
- **in addition** = also
- **in-between** = here: between two meals
- **infection** = bacteria or virus that gets into a plant
- **load** = put onto
- **merchant** = a person in the Middle Ages , who bought and sold things
- **navigator** = explorer; person on a ship who plans which way it should go
- **nutrient** = chemical or food that gives us what we need to grow and survive
- **overlapping** = when one thing lies on top of the other
- **plantation** = large area of land in a hot country , where crops, like tea, cotton sugar etc.. are grown
- **popular**=widespread, liked by many people
- **potassium** = silver- white metal that is used in farming
- **prevent** = stop
- **protein** = a natural substance that exists in food , like eggs, meat and beans; our body needs it to grow and stay strong and healthy
- **reduce** = lower
- **ripe** = ready to be eaten
- **soil**= top layer of the earth on which plants grow
- **Spaniard** = person from Spain
- **stalk** = thick stem of a plant
- **staple diet** = main food of a country
- **state** = condition
- **stem** = thick part of a plant that grows out of the ground
- **store** = keep in a place for some time, until it is needed
- **stroke** = when a blood vessel is blocked and blood cannot flow through
- **tax** = money that you must pay to the government , depending on how high your income is or how much money you have
- **trade** = buying and selling products
- **valuable** = expensive, worth a lot
- **wages** = money you get for the work you do
- **well-drained** = here: when water can flow away and does not stay on the surface of the earth
- **wheat** = grain that white bread is made out of

INSECTS

About 75% of the world's animals are insects. They have been living on earth for over 400 million years, long before **humans appeared**. Insects have changed a lot and **adapted** to new climates in order to **survive**. Today, there are about one million different **species** of insects and **scientists** are **discovering** new groups daily. Insects have different sizes and body forms. Most of them are very small but they can grow as large as 30 cm. Among the most **common** insects are flies, **beetles**, bees, butterflies, moths and **wasps**.

Where insects live

Insects live in every region of the world. They can survive in any type of climate, from tropical rainforests to **icy** polar regions, as long as they can find food. The oceans are the only places where few insects live. Because they are so small, they can live in places where other animals cannot survive, some even live in underground **caves**.

Physical features

Insects belong to a group of animals called arthropods. They do not have a **skeleton** but a kind of **shell** that **protects** them. This exoskeleton is very **tight** and does not grow with the insect. When an insect becomes too large for the shell it breaks open and a new shell **develops**.

Insects have three major body parts: head, **thorax** and **abdomen**. They have six legs and at least one pair of feelers.

An insect's **antennae**, mouth and eyes are located in the head.

The **compound** eyes **consist** of up to 4,000 **separate lenses** that combine images inside an insect's brain. Such a **complex** eye gives it extremely good **eyesight**. Insects use antennae to smell and feel. If their feelers are **damaged** they become helpless.

The thorax has three pairs of legs and two pairs of wings, **however**, some insects have no wings at all.

The abdomen is the largest part of an insect.

It **contains organs** that **digest** food, **release waste** and let insects **reproduce**.

How insects behave

Insects protect themselves from **enemies** in many ways. Some can **blend** into their **surroundings** by changing their colours. Others, like beetles, have a hard shell that **protects** them. Some insects produce **poison** and inject it into enemies by biting or **stinging** them.

Most insects live alone but there are some **social** insects that live in **colonies**. **Termites**, ants and bees are examples of insects that live in groups of thousands or even millions, in which everything is organized and each insect has a certain **task**. Such a society is **headed** by a leader, a queen or a king, whom others **follow**.

Insects eat plants, animals and other **organisms**. They also live on other animals and get food from their body. Such insects are called parasites.

Certain insects migrate during the wintertime. The monarch butterfly, for example, flies south to tropical and subtropical areas. In spring they come back to their original **habitat**.

Life cycle of insects

Most insects are born from eggs. Their **covering** or shell cannot grow and they break out of it after a certain time. After that an insect grows a new shell. This process is called

moulting. An insect can **moult** many times until it becomes a fully grown **adult**. This **process**, from **hatching** out of an egg to becoming an adult, can take between a few days and many years. As an adult, most insects live only for a short time. But there are a few, like the queen of a termite colony, which can live for many years.

Some insects change **completely** during the different **stages** of their life. This is called metamorphosis. After hatching from an egg they become a larva, which takes on a wormlike **shape**. A larva eats a lot and **moults** several times during its **development process**. After growth an insect becomes a pupa. It **spins** a protective covering around itself. During this **resting stage** an insect **develops** wings and legs and other body **features**. In the final **stage** an adult **emerges** from the pupa. Bees and butterflies grow in this way.

Insects and humans

Insects can be helpful to humans in many ways. They eat other insects and dangerous animals that may **endanger** fields and **crops**. They keep our **environment** clean by eating animal waste and other unwanted **substances**. Some produce **valuable** products like honey and **silk**. Flowers, fruits and other plants **depend on** insects to help **spread pollen**. On the other side, insects are an important **source** of food for birds, frogs and other animals.

There are very few **harmful** types of insects, but they can do a lot of damage. Some of them spread diseases by **stinging** and biting people. In tropical regions insects are the main **carriers** of malaria or the plague. They **injure** pets and animals, and do damage to trees and crops.

Words

- **adapt** to = get used to
- **adult** = here: fully grown animal
- **antenna** = one of two long thin parts on an insect's head, which it uses to feel
- **appear** = show up; come to life
- **beetle** = an insect with a round hard back, which is usually black
- **blend into** = to match with the world around you so that you cannot be seen
- **carrier** = here: animal or plant that can spread things to other places
- **cave** = a natural hole in the side of a hill or under the ground
- **certain** = special
- **colony** = group of animals that live together
- **common** = widespread
- **completely** = totally
- **complex** = consisting of many different parts
- **compound** = consisting of many parts
- **consist of** = are made up of
- **covering** = hard skin

- **crops** = a plant, like wheat and rice, which is grown by farmers and sold as food
- **damage** = destroy
- **depend on** = need
- **develop** = grow
- **development process** = here: the time during which something grows
- **digest** = change food into substances the body can use
- **discover** = find for the first time
- **emerge** = come out of
- **endanger** = put in danger
- **enemy** = here: animals that want to hurt them
- **environment** = the world around us
- **eyesight** = the ability to see
- **feature** = part
- **follow** = go after
- **habitat** = living area
- **harmful** = dangerous
- **hatch** = break out of a shell
- **head** = lead
- **however** = but
- **humans** = people
- **icy** = very cold
- **injure** = hurt
- **lens** = the clear part inside your eye that focuses so you can see things clearly
- **migrate** = move to live and eat somewhere else
- **moth** = an insect that is related to the butterfly; it flies at night and eats holes in cloth
- **moult** = to lose old skin and grow new skin
- **organ** = part of the body that has a certain job to do
- **organism** = here: living things
- **plague** = disease that causes death and spreads quickly to a large number of people
- **poison** = substance that can lead to death or a serious illness
- **pollen** = fine powder which plants produce and which is carried to other flowers and plants by insects
- **process** = development , way of growing
- **protect** = guard, defend
- **release** = let free
- **reproduce** = to have babies

- **resting stage** = time during which it does not grow
- **scientist** = person who works in a laboratory and is trained in science
- **separate** = different
- **shape** = form
- **shell** = hard skin
- **silk** = smooth soft cloth made from material that is produced by the silkworm
- **skeleton** = structure consisting of all the bones of the body
- **social** = group
- **source** = where something comes from
- **species** = a group of animals or plants that are almost the same and can have babies together
- **spin** = here: to produce skin
- **spread** = here: bring from one place to another
- **stage** = phase, period, time
- **sting** = to make a very small holes in your skin and you feel a sharp pain
- **substance** = material
- **surroundings** = the world around us
- **survive** = live on, exist
- **task** = job
- **termite** = insect that eats and destroys wood from trees and buildings
- **thorax** = the part of an insect's body between its head and abdomen
- **tight** = stiff, fixed, not flexible
- **valuable** = expensive
- **wasp** = a thin black and yellow insect that can sting you
- **waste** = the solid material that comes out of your body



SUGAR

Sugar is used as a **sweetener** all over the world. People sugar all sorts of food and drinks to make them taste better. Sugar is often **added** to tea or coffee and to **certain** types of **pastries**. The food industry adds sugar to **soft drinks** and ice cream.

Sugar is a simple **carbohydrate**, a **substance** that gives us energy. **However**, too much sugar can be **harmful**. It can cause obesity and tooth decay. People who **consume** too much sugar can be **hyperactive**. That is why some people use **artificial** sweeteners **instead of** sugar.

Types of sugar

Our sugar is also **referred to** as sucrose. It is made up of two **basic** components. Glucose comes from the carbohydrates that we eat. Our body changes them to energy and transports them into the bloodstream. Fructose **occurs** naturally, **especially** in fruits, vegetables and honey. When we eat an apple or orange fructose is changed into glucose and goes into our blood.

Lactose, or milk sugar, is found in **dairy products**. Some adults are not able to **digest** milk sugar and should not **consume** dairy products.

How sugar is produced

Sugar can be **manufactured** from two natural products: sugar cane and sugar **beets**. About 70% of the world's 200 million tons of sugar comes from sugar cane.

Sugar beets grow in **temperate climates** of the world. Sugar is **contained** the white roots of the beet. These beets are **dug out** of the ground and brought to a **factory**, where they are washed and cut. **Afterwards** they are heated to a juicy **mixture**. As the juice **evaporates** sugar crystals start to form. They are separated from the juice and **processed** further. **Raw** sugar is brown or yellow. It is chemically **bleached** to make it white. Then sugar is **packaged** and sold. The syrup that is **eventually** left over is called molasses.

Sugar cane is in the **stalks** of a tall plant that grows in the tropical regions. Brazil, India and China are the world's largest producers of sugar cane. When the stalks are **ripe** they are **harvested** and **crushed** in a special machine that **squeezes** out the sugar **liquid**. The process after that is **similar** to the way sugar beets are processed.

History of sugar

Sugar has been known for a long time. Early **inhabitants** of Pacific Island used sugar thousands of years ago. Sugar cane was also grown in **ancient** India and in other cultures. Sugar reached Europe at the beginning of the Middle Ages. During the Age of Exploration **navigators** brought sugar to Africa and America, where it was planted in the southern colonies of the United States.

Words

- **add** = put into
- **afterwards** = after that
- **artificial** = not natural; man-made
- **basic** = main

- **beet** = a vegetable, the root of which can be cooked
- **bleach** = to make something white or pale
- **bloodstream** = the blood flowing through paths in the body
- **carbohydrate** = stuff that is in sugar, bread, potatoes etc.. which gives your body heat and energy; it is made up of oxygen, carbon and hydrogen
- **certain** = special
- **consume** = eat
- **crush** = break into small pieces
- **dairy product** = products that come from the cow, like milk, cheese, butter etc..
- **digest** = to change food into substances that the body can use
- **dig out** = to get something out of the ground
- **evaporate** = to change into a gas
- **eventually** = in the end
- **factory** = place where something is produced
- **harmful** = dangerous
- **harvest** = gather or bring in crops from the field
- **hyperactive** = not able to keep still for very long
- **inhabitant** = a person who lives in a place
- **instead of** = in something's place
- **manufacture** = produce
- **mixture** = a combination of two or more substances
- **navigator** = person on a ship who plans which way to go
- **obesity** = if someone is too fat
- **occur** = can be found
- **package** = to put into boxes
- **pastry** = a mixture of flour, butter and milk used to make pies and other baked food
- **process** = to change or preserve food so that it is ready to be sold
- **raw** = natural, pure
- **refer to** = called
- **ripe** = fully grown
- **soft drink** = cold drink that does not have alcohol in it
- **squeeze** = to press something together
- **stalk** = the long narrow part of a plant
- **substance** = stuff, material
- **sweetener** = a substance that makes food sweeter
- **tooth decay** = when your tooth has a hole in it and is slowly damaged

COFFEE

Coffee is one of the most **popular** hot drinks in the world. Almost a third of the world's **population** drinks coffee. People often meet at cafes or coffee shops for a **coffee break** during the middle of the morning or stop work in the afternoon to drink coffee.

About 7 million tons of coffee are produced every year. Brazil is, **by far**, the world's largest coffee producer. About a third of the world's production comes from this South American country. Other coffee producing countries **include** Vietnam, Indonesia and Columbia.

The United States is the biggest coffee **consumer** in the world. About 1.2 **billion** kilograms of coffee are consumed there every year. Drinking coffee is **extremely** popular in European countries, like Italy, France and Germany, as well as in Brazil.

The coffee plant

Coffee grows as a green-leaved tree or bush with **blossoming** white flowers. The coffee **shrub originally** comes from Ethiopia but, in the **course of time spread** to Southeast Asia and South America.

There are two **basic** types of coffee. Arabica **accounts for** about 70% of the world's coffee production. It is grown in the higher regions of central and South America and is popular for its **flavor** and **fragrance**. Robusta has **spread** throughout central and eastern Africa. **Although** it makes up only thirty per cent of the total coffee production it has become more important because it can **resist** diseases better. It also has smaller beans and can grow at lower **altitudes** than Arabica.

Coffee plants grow in the warm and **moist climate** of the tropics and subtropics. Most coffee trees grow best between 1000 and 2500 meters above **sea level**.

Coffee trees produce fruits called **berries**. At first they are yellow, and then become red as they **mature**. An **average** coffee tree can produce enough berries to make about a pound (half a kilo) of **roasted** coffee.

Coffee **seeds** are grown in **nursery beds**. After a year they are planted in specially prepared fields. It takes a coffee tree about six years to produce a **full harvest** of coffee berries. The largest ones can get up to six meters tall, but they are normally **trimmed** to a **height** of 1.5 to 4 meters.

Harvesting and processing coffee

Most coffee berries are **picked** by hand, which makes sure that only the good berries are used. After **separating** berries from leaves and other **waste** materials, the beans are then taken out, cleaned and dried. Only the best beans make it to the **market**. Then they are put into bags and shipped to countries where they are **roasted**.

At their **destination** the beans are **combined** to make different **blends** of coffee. Roasting for about 15 minutes brings out the true **flavor** of the coffee. The roasted coffee beans are **packaged**; some of them are **crushed** to **ground coffee**.

Effects of coffee

Coffee **contains** caffeine, a **substance** that **stimulates** parts of the body, **especially** heart and muscles. People often drink coffee to help them stay awake or keep them alert. **Although** coffee has some negative effects it is not thought to be a **harmful** drink. Children and people who have heart problems should not drink coffee in great **quantities**. In **decaffeinated** coffee the caffeine is **extracted** in a chemical process.

How coffee is brewed.

Coffee must be **ground** before it is **brewed**. Grounding usually **takes place** inside a coffee machine, but you can also buy ground coffee in shops. The simplest **brewing** process is **pouring boiling water** over a **filter** of ground coffee and letting it **flow** into a **pot**. Coffee is often made by using simple machines that **force** hot water through a **pad** of pressed coffee. Espresso machines press hot water through ground coffee.

Instant coffee is made by pouring hot water over **powdery** coffee. It **dissolves** at once and you do not need a special machine.

History of coffee

Coffee **originated** in the east African **highlands** in the 6th **century**. It was then brought to Arabia where people used it as food and medicine. During the 11th century the first coffee drinks came up. In the 16th and 17th **centuries** coffee became **widely popular** in Europe when the Turks brought it to Central Europe. In the 17th and 18th century coffee **conquered** North and South America

Coffee houses soon became **popular** all over the world. In the 1900s **chains** of coffee shops **developed** in Europe and America. Today, Starbucks is the largest coffeehouse **chain** in the world, with over 20,000 stores in 60 countries.

Types of Coffee drinks

- Espresso is probably the most popular coffee drink in the world. It is made by **forcing** hot water through a **pad** filled with dark ground coffee. **Although** there is not much coffee in the cup an espresso is very strong. It is usually drunk black, with no milk **added**.
- Americano is an espresso with hot water added to make it weaker.
- Café Latte is an espresso with a lot of hot milk and **foam** added on the top
- Cappuccino is a cup of espresso, together with warm milk and a lot of milk **foam** at the top. In some coffee shops it is **decorated** with **flaked** chocolate or cocoa.
- Cafe Mocha is a cappuccino with chocolate or cocoa added
- Frappe is a cold espresso that you can get at some coffee shops during the hot summer months
- Turkish coffee is usually thicker than normal coffee. It is made by **combining** ground coffee and water to a **muddy** mixture

Words

- **account for** = to produce a certain amount of
- **add** = put into
- **although** = while
- **altitude** = height
- **average** = normal
- **basic** = main, important
- **berry** = small fruit or seed of a plant

- **billion** = a thousand million
- **blend** = when you mix many different types
- **blossom** = when a tree produces flowers
- **boiling** = very very hot
- **brew** = when the taste of coffee or tea gets into hot water
- **by far** = much more or better than anything else
- **century** = a hundred years
- **chain** = shops owned by the same company
- **coffee break** = a short time when you stop working and have a cup of coffee
- **combine** = put together
- **conquer** = here: to become popular in
- **consumer** = here: country whose people drink a lot of coffee
- **contain** = to have in it
- **course of time** = as time goes on
- **crush** = to press something into many small pieces
- **decaffeinated** = without caffeine
- **decorate** = to make something look prettier
- **destination** = place where something is going to
- **develop** = grow
- **dissolve** = melt, break up
- **especially** = above all
- **extract** = take out
- **extremely** = very
- **filter** = material that you pour something into and only the liquid gets through
- **flaked** = small thin pieces of
- **flavor** = taste , aroma
- **flow** = run. move smoothly through
- **foam** = when liquid turns into a mass of bubbles
- **force** = make something happen
- **fragrance** = nice smell
- **full harvest** = here: when trees can produce the highest amount of coffee
- **ground coffee** = to use a machine to break into powder or very small pieces
- **harmful** = dangerous
- **height** = how high something is
- **highlands** = high, flat areas
- **include** = are also

- **instant coffee** = coffee in powdery form
- **market** = place where you buy and sell something
- **mature** = be become fully grown or ripe
- **moist** = wet
- **muddy** = not clear
- **nursery bed** = place where new plants and trees are grown
- **originally** = at first
- **originate** = come from
- **package** = put into boxes or bags
- **pad** = here: filling
- **pick** = harvest
- **popular** = liked by many people
- **population** = people
- **pot** = container
- **pour** = to make a liquid flow out of something
- **powdery** = to break into very very small pieces
- **process** = to make a product ready to be sold
- **quantity** = amount
- **resist** = to defend itself against
- **roast** = to heat quickly so that you give something a certain taste
- **sea level** = the average height of the sea, used as a standard for measuring mountain peaks and other objects
- **seed** = small hard object of a plant from which a new plant can grow
- **separate** = divide , split
- **shrub** = bush, plant
- **spread** = expand from one place to another
- **stimulate** = to make something become active
- **substance** = stuff, material
- **take place** = happen
- **trim** = cut
- **waste** = not needed
- **widely** = very



FISH

Fish are animals that live in water. They are **vertebrates**, animals with **backbones**, and come in all kinds of **shapes**, sizes and colors. Fish first **appeared** in the oceans of the Earth about 500 million years ago, long before dinosaurs **roamed** our planet. Today there are tens of thousands of different kinds of fish and new **species** are **discovered** every year. Over millions of years fish have changed their features and **adapted** to their **surroundings** in order to **survive**.

The whale shark is the largest fish on Earth. It can grow up to 12 meters in **length** and can **weigh** up to 15 tons. **In contrast** tiny gobies are often only a few mm long.

Fish are important to people. They were among the first animals hunted by primitive **human beings**. Millions of people all over the world **depend on** fish as a main form of nutrition. In many **coastal** countries, for example Japan or Norway, people depend on fishing to make a living.

Fish are a part of the food chain. They eat animals and are eaten by other sea **creatures**, **thus** keeping up the balance of nature.

Where fish live

Fish live all over the world, in the cold water of the Arctic as well as in warm tropical water around the equator. **Areas** rich in fish are **especially** around the **coastal shelves** of the Northern Atlantic, the Caribbean Sea and the western Pacific Ocean.

Most of the world's fish live in salt water. They **preferably** live in areas where warm and cold **currents** meet. Some types live in the warm tropical waters around coral reefs.

About 40% of all fish **species** are in fresh water. They **include** carp, **catfish**, **trout** or bass. Some of them live in the clear water of rivers while others prefer **muddy** pond water. A few types of fish can swim in both salt and fresh water. **Salmon**, for example, are born in fresh water, **migrate** to the ocean and then return to fresh water to **reproduce**.

Bodies of fish

Fish have no neck. The head and body are **combined** to one. Most species have a **skeleton** made of bone, only a few **species** have backbones made of **cartilage**.

Most fish are shaped like cigars or torpedoes, so that they can travel very quickly. Fish that swim near the ocean floor are flat-shaped. **Eels** look like long snakes under water.

Fish are cold-blooded. Their body temperature changes with their surroundings. Almost all fish have **fins**, instead of arms and legs, which they use for swimming.

The skin of most fish is made out of a special **slippery substance**. It is covered by small **plates** called **scales**. Some scales have special cells that give fish a certain color.

Fish breathe **oxygen** from the water they live in. **Gills** on the side of a fish's head **absorb** oxygen from the water and **release** carbon dioxide into it.

Some animals in the oceans of the world look like fish but are actually mammals. Dolphins and whales have lungs and must come up to the **surface** for air.

Senses

Fish have organs that tell them what is happening in the water around them. They can see left and right at the same time. **Although** they have no **physical** ears they have hearing

organs on the side of their head. They not only can hear sounds in the water but can also **sense** sounds that happen on the surface.

All fish have a sense of smell. In some species, for example sharks and salmon, it is **highly developed**. Fish can also feel **pressure** of water **movements**, thus feeling dangers that **approach** them.

Fish have a special sense called the lateral line. It is a **row** of cells that works like **radar** and help them **navigate** through waters.

How fish live

Most fish eat meat, preferably other fish. They also eat plants, worms and **algae**. The largest fish in the world **consume** huge masses of **plankton**.

Fish have to **protect** themselves from being eaten by other fish. They blend into their **surroundings** by changing their color or their shape. Some fish are very fast swimmers and get away from their enemies very quickly. Others **release poisonous substances** from their **spines**.

Although most fish are **harmless** to humans some will attack if **provoked**. Sharks attack humans if they smell blood or if people make uncontrolled movements. Piranhas live in the waters of the tropical rainforest. They **attack** their victims with their sharp teeth and tear their **flesh** apart.

How fish reproduce

Fish **reproduce** by **releasing** male sperm and female eggs into the water at the same time. The process of joining together is called spawning. Eggs are food for other fish. Many females release hundreds of thousands of eggs to make sure that at least some of the young ones can **survive**.

Many fish leave their eggs after spawning. Some of them stay and protect their eggs until they **hatch**. Salmon cover their eggs with sand and **gravel**.

Danger to fish

Fish are caught for a number of reasons. **Apart from providing** food for millions of people they are used for **animal feed** and to produce oil.

Overfishing in the world's oceans poses a **threat** to many species. Some are in danger of dying out. **Catch quotas** have been introduced to save some of the most important species. Fish are also **endangered** by **pollution** of the world's oceans.

Words

- **absorb** = take in
- **adapt** = to change and get used to a new situation
- **algae** = very simple plant without leaves that grows in or near water
- **although** = while
- **appear** = here: exist
- **approach** = to come towards something
- **area** = place

- **attack** = use violence to hurt someone
- **backbone** = a row of connected bones that go down the middle of your back
- **carbon dioxide** = gas that animals breathe out
- **cartilage** = strong substance that can bend; it is around the moveable parts of your body
- **catfish** = fish that has whiskers around its mouth and lives in rivers and lakes
- **coastal** = in the sea near the coast
- **coastal shelf** = edge of a continent where it slopes down steeply to the bottom of the sea
- **combine** = unite, join
- **consume** = eat
- **creature** = living thing
- **current** = movement of water in the ocean
- **depend on** = need
- **discover** = to find for the first time
- **eel** = long thin fish that looks like a snake
- **especially** = above all
- **fin** = thin body part that a fish uses to swim
- **flesh** = soft part of a person or animal that is between the skin and the bones
- **food chain** = a plant or animal is eaten by another plant or animal; this goes on over and over again
- **gill** = organ on the side of a fish through which it breathes
- **harmless** = not dangerous
- **highly developed** = very good
- **human being** = person
- **in contrast** = on the other side, in comparison
- **include** = consist of
- **length** = how long something is
- **mammal** = type of animal that drinks milk from its mother when it is young
- **migrate** = move, travel
- **movement** = the way something moves
- **muddy** = dull, not clear
- **navigate** = to find your way around
- **nutrition** = food
- **oxygen** = gas that has no color or smell and that is in the air that we breathe
- **physical** = bodily ; an organ you can touch

- **plankton** = very small forms of plant and animal life that live in water and are eaten by fish
- **plate** = thin piece used as a cover
- **poisonous** = deadly
- **preferably** = if possible
- **pressure** = weight, force
- **protect** = defend
- **provoke** = to make angry
- **radar** = machine that uses radio waves to find the position of things
- **release** = set free
- **reproduce** = lay eggs that young fish come out of
- **roam** = wander around
- **row** = line
- **salmon** = large fish with silver skin that lives in the sea but swims up rivers to lay its eggs
- **scale** = small flat piece of skin
- **sense** = to feel that something exists
- **shape** = form
- **skeleton** = structure of bones
- **slippery** = oily, greasy
- **species** = group of plant or animals whose members are almost the same and can have babies together
- **spine** = row of bones down the center of your back
- **substance** = material
- **surface** = top layer of something
- **surroundings** = the world around you
- **survive** = to live on after a dangerous situation
- **thus** = therefore
- **trout** = common river fish that can be eaten
- **vertebrate** = a living creature that has a backbone
- **weigh** = how heavy something is



MUMMIES

When a person dies their body **decays**. Skin and **flesh disappear** and as time goes on only a skeleton is left. A mummy is the dead body of a person or an animal that has been **preserved by wrapping cloth** or other material around it. Mummies have been found all over the world, most of them in Egypt. **However**, other cultures in South America and Asia also **mummified** their dead.

The oldest mummy ever found **dates back** to 6,000 years before Christ. The British Museum in London **currently displays** the oldest Egyptian mummy, dating back to 3400 BC. The British **archaeologist** Howard Carter **discovered** the **remains of Tutankhamun** in 1922, probably the most famous mummy in the world.

Today **scientists** study mummies with special **equipment** and X-ray machines. They discover more about the bodies of **ancient** people and how they lived. They can also find **clues** to what they ate and what kind of **diseases** they had.

Mummification also **occurs due to** extreme weather. Mummies have been found in the cold regions of the world, **including the Alps** and the Himalaya mountains. Salt water also helps **preserve** bodies. Mummies have been found in deserts and in **peat bogs**. The most famous natural mummy is Ötzi, the Iceman, found in a glacier on the Austrian-Italian border in 1991.

Egyptian mummies

Egyptian society mummified their dead for many centuries. They believed that they had to preserve the body for life after death. The soul of the dead would be **reunited** with its body in the **afterlife**. At first, they started burying dead people in hot sand; later on, they built special **tombs**. Egyptians wanted their relatives to feel comfortable after death.

Later on bodies were wrapped in cloth to stop bacteria and other **harmful substances** from getting to them. **Embalmers dehydrated** bodies and **removed** all **liquids** from within. A substance called **natron** was used to cover the bodies. It **extracted moisture** from the skin and flesh. Inner organs, **including the brain**, were removed; the heart was usually left in the body. Mummies often **received** a face mask.

Mummies were then put into **coffins**, made out of wood or stone. Relatives **decorated** them and buried them under ground. The extracted inner organs were put into **jars** and **placed** next to the mummies. Sometimes animals were also mummified and put next to their **owners**.

Poor people did not have the money for such **complicated procedures**. Mummifying **pharaohs** and noblemen, on the other hand, **proved** to be a special and **demanding** job. In ancient Egypt, it took 70 days to finish a **complete** mummification process.

Other Mummies

The Inca in Peru mummified dead people by using salt. In other areas, the dry climate helped **preserve** mummies.

Mummification still occurs today in some societies. Mao Zedong and Lenin were famous Communist leaders who were **embalmed**.

Words

- **afterlife** = life that some people believe comes after death
- **ancient** = old
- **archaeologist** = person who studies ancient societies and civilisations and carefully observes what is left of them or their buildings
- **bacteria** = very small living things that can cause diseases
- **brain** = organ inside your head that controls how you move, feel or think
- **cloth** = material used for making clothes
- **clue** = sign, information
- **coffin** = long box which a dead body is put into
- **complete** = whole
- **complicated** = difficult, complex
- **currently** = at the moment
- **date back** = exist during a time in the past
- **decay** = to fall apart; destroyed by nature
- **decorate** = to paint figures on something
- **dehydrate** = dry out
- **demanding** = very difficult
- **desert** = area of dry land
- **disappear** = go away
- **discover** = to find for the first time
- **disease** = illness
- **display** = show; something that people can see
- **due to** = because of
- **embalmer** = person who treats a dead body with chemicals in order to preserve it
- **equipment** = machines, tools
- **extract** = take out
- **flesh** = soft part of a person, between the skin and the bones
- **glacier** = mass of ice that moves down a river valley
- **harmful** = dangerous
- **however** = but
- **including** = also
- **jar** = small container or pot
- **liquid** = watery material
- **moisture** = wetness
- **mummify** = to make a person into a mummy
- **natron** = sodium carbonate; kind of salt

- **occur** = happen
- **owner** = a person who something belongs to
- **peat bog** = area of wet land in which dead bodies of animals and plants fall apart; the black soil that is created can be burned and used as a form energy
- **pharaoh** = king in ancient Egypt
- **place** = put
- **preserve** = to save something from being destroyed or damaged
- **procedure** = technique, method
- **prove** = shown to be true
- **receive** = get
- **remains** = parts of a dead body
- **remove** = take out
- **reunite** = bring back together
- **scientist** = person who is trained in science and works in a laboratory
- **society** = people in general
- **substance** = material
- **tomb** = stone structure above or below the ground where a dead person is buried
- **wrap** = cover something with a certain material
- **x-ray** = lines of light that can go through objects; used for taking pictures of the inner parts of a person's body



JEANS

Jeans have become one of the most worn pieces of **clothing** in the world. Everybody wears them, from the **rural** farmer to the **urban lawyer** and from models to housewives. But why have jeans become so **popular**. You'll get many answers. For some people they look cool, for others jeans are simply comfortable.

Jeans were first designed as **durable** trousers for farm workers and **miners** in the states of the American west. A Nevada **tailor**, Jacob Davis, had the idea of using **copper bolts** at the corner of the pockets to make them stronger. They became popular **instantly** and soon many people bought them.

Although Davis knew that he had a great product which many people wanted to buy, he didn't have the money to **patent** it. He asked Levi Strauss, who **supplied** him with **cloth**, to help him out. The two worked together and started making jeans out of **denim**, which was more comfortable and could be easily **stretched**. It also became softer as it got older. They were dyed with **indigo** because it did not go through the cloth like other **dyes** do.

At first jeans were worn only by workers, **especially** in factories. In the eastern part of the US jeans were **hardly** worn at all. They were **associated** with **rural** people and the working class. But when rich easterners went on holidays to **escape** everyday life they often put on jeans.

James Dean and Marlon Brando made them popular in movies and everyone wanted to wear them. Jeans became a symbol of the youth rebellion during the 1950s and 1960s. College students started to wear them as a protest against the Vietnam War and the **establishment**. The new trousers were **banned** in American schools and sometimes in theatres and cinemas. As time went on jeans became more **acceptable** and today they are worn not only as **casual** clothes but also at **formal** events.

Other countries quickly started to get **accustomed** to wearing jeans too.

American **servicemen on duty** in Europe and Japan often wore them when they were not on duty to show that they were Americans. The trousers showed the world a happier way of life, something that people needed, especially after what they had **endured** in World War II.

Jeans were also worn because they made people **equal**. You could **afford** them and they couldn't be **torn** so easily. They had **practical advantages** as well. They didn't need to be washed as often as other trousers and women didn't need to **iron** them. This became more important as more and more women started working and had less time for housework.

Today jeans are an **essential** part of our lives. They are almost always washed a few times before being sold to give them their **faded appearance**.

Words

- **acceptable** = good enough, all right
- **accustomed** = to get used to
- **advantage** = good side
- **afford** = to have enough money to buy something
- **although** = while

- **appearance** = how something looks
- **associate** = connect, link
- **ban** = forbid
- **bolt** = a metal piece used to hold things together
- **casual** = relaxed
- **cloth** = material used for making clothes
- **clothing** = clothes, outfit
- **copper** = soft reddish brown metal
- **denim** = strong cotton cloth
- **durable** = strong; hard-wearing
- **dye** = color
- **endure** = to go through
- **equal** = the same
- **escape** = get away from
- **especially** = above all
- **essential** = very important
- **establishment** = group of people who have a lot of power in a country
- **fade** = lose color
- **formal** = official
- **hardly** = not very much
- **indigo** = dark blue color
- **instantly** = at once
- **iron** = to make clothes smooth and flat
- **lawyer** = a person who has studied law
- **miner** = a person who works mostly underground and digs minerals out of the earth
- **on duty** = to work
- **patent** = to get the rights to produce something
- **popular** = liked by many
- **practical** = useful
- **rural** = country side
- **serviceman** = member of the army
- **stretch** = to make flexible
- **supply** = sell
- **tailor** = someone who makes clothes
- **tear - tore- torn** = break
- **urban** = from the city

CHRISTMAS

Christians all over the world **celebrate** the birth of Christ on December 25. It is a **joyous** holiday where families get together, give each other presents, **decorate** houses, sing traditional songs and go to **mass**.

The word Christmas comes from the old English "Christes Maesse", which means Christ's **mass**. **Although** Christians believe that Jesus was born in the small town of Bethlehem, we don't know the **exact** date of birth because stories about Jesus Christ were written down much later.

By the 4th **century** Christians were **divided** into two churches: the eastern church was in Constantinople, today's Istanbul, and the western church was **based** in Rome. Each church **celebrated** Christmas on different days. The eastern church **chose** January 6 and the western church **chose** December 25.

Today, most countries **celebrate** the Christmas holidays from December 25 until January 6. Many Christians **celebrate** this day as **Epiphany**, the day on which the three **wise** men came to visit baby Jesus.

Christmas customs

Giving presents is a special part of Christmas. In many countries magical **figures** like Santa Claus or Father Christmas bring children their **gifts**.

Decorating the house is an old **custom** that comes from **pagan** times. In northern Europe **branches** from **evergreen** trees were brought into the house to show that spring would return soon.

Our traditional Christmas tree also comes from northern Europe. In the Middle Ages people **set up** trees and hung apples on them. As time went on more and more objects were **added** : **candles** , cookies , **mistletoe** and other things. German **settlers** brought the Christmas tree to America. Today families **decorate** their trees with **ornaments** , **glitter** , **candy cane** and electric lights. Some people even put up trees outdoors in their garden.

Christmas cards started to become **popular** in the middle of the 19th **century** . Today, **billions** of cards are sent all over the world.

In medieval Europe Christmas was a **celebration** of **feasting** and dancing. Nowadays many families enjoy special meals. Turkey, goose, **duck** , fish, roast beef are some of the many **dishes** that you can find on dinner tables around the world. Housewives bake cakes and cookies.

Christmas is also a time of singing carols, songs that come from folk songs and **ballads**. Most of the carols we sing today were written in the 1800s. "Silent Night, Holy Night" is the most **popular** song. It is sung all over the world.

Many Christians **attend mass** on Christmas Eve or Christmas Day. In some churches children **act out** the story of the birth of Christ and people go to midnight mass.

Christmas in other countries

In America children hang **stockings** over the fireplace. When they are asleep Santa Claus arrives with his **reindeer**, **slides** down the **chimney** and fills them with presents.

British children **receive** their **gifts** from Father Christmas. They enjoy a Christmas dinner of **roast** turkey and **mince pie** or **plum pudding**. People often go around from house to house and sing carols.

Children in France welcome the visit of Pere Noël. They leave shoes by the fireplace so that he can fill them with **gifts**. After midnight mass many families have a special **supper** called "Le reveillon". They eat a "Buche de Noël", a special cake that looks like a **log**.

In many Italian homes a **nativity scene** called "presepio" is the centre of **celebrations**. Many families have fried **eel**, called "capitone", as a Christmas Eve **supper**. Other special **dishes** are "panetone", a bread with dried fruit, and "torrone", **candy** made with nuts and honey. On Epiphany "La Befana", a nice witch, brings children presents.

In Sweden, Christmas presents are brought by Jultomten, who has **elves** as helpers. In this northern European country the Christmas season begins on December 13—St. Lucia Day. On this day the oldest daughter of the house puts on a white dress and wears a **wreath** with **candles** on her head. She serves coffee and **buns** to the rest of her family.

For German and Austrian children **festivities** begin on December 6, when St. Nicholas comes to their homes and gives them a bag filled with sweets, oranges and nuts. Christmas presents are brought by the "Weihnachtsmann" or "Christkind". Families like to eat stollen, bread filled with fruits.

In Bethlehem, a small town in today's Israel, there is a colourful **procession** on Christmas Eve. People walk through the **narrow** streets and carry a picture of Jesus in a **cradle** to the **Church of Nativity**. There it is put into a glass **manger**. **Pilgrims** from all over the world travel to Bethlehem to take part.

In Mexico children have a Christmas party and hang a "piñata", on a **rope** from the **ceiling**. This is an **earthenware jug** or a paper figure that is filled with candy or small toys. Then they **blindfold** themselves and try to hit it with a stick until it breaks and the sweets and toys fall out. Many people take part in **processions** that show how Mary and Joseph **searched** for a place to stay in Bethlehem.

In the southern **hemisphere** Christmas comes during the hot summer season. In Brazil people have outdoor picnics and **fireworks**. Australians **gather** outdoors and spend the holidays on sandy beaches. For pupils it's the end of the school year and the beginning of the summer holidays.

Words

- **act out** = to perform a small play
- **add** = to put together with something else
- **although** = while
- **ballad** = a slow song
- **based** = to be the centre of something
- **billion** = a thousand million
- **blindfold** = to cover someone's eyes with a piece of cloth
- **branch** = a part of a tree that has leaves on it
- **bun** = small round bread



- **candle** = a stick of wax that burns and gives light
- **candy** = sweet food made from sugar
- **candy cane** = a stick of hard red and white sugar that has a curved end
- **ceiling** = the top part of a room
- **celebrate** = to do something
- **celebration** = event of celebrating
- **century** = a hundred years
- **chimney** = a part of a house from which smoke comes out
- **choose, chose** = to decide what you want to have or do
- **Church of Nativity** = church that was built over the birthplace of Jesus
- **cradle** = a small bed for a baby
- **custom** = tradition
- **decorate** = to make something look nice by putting pretty things on it
- **dish** = meal
- **divide** = to split into parts
- **duck** = a water bird with short legs and a wide mouth
- **earthenware** = made of baked clay
- **eel** = a long thin fish that looks like a snake and can be eaten
- **attend** = to go to
- **elf, elves** = a small person with pointed ears and magical power
- **Epiphany** = January 6 , a day on which the Three Kings came to see Jesus
- **evergreen** = it does not lose its leaves in the winter
- **exact** = completely correct
- **feasting** = to eat a lot of food on a special day
- **festivities** = celebrations
- **figure** = person or character
- **fireworks** = small container filled with powder that burns or explodes to produce coloured lights and noise in the sky
- **gather** = get together
- **gift** = present
- **glitter** = pieces of shiny paper
- **hemisphere** = half of the world
- **joyous** = very happy
- **jug** = container with a wide curved opening at the top used for holding liquids
- **log** = a thick piece of wood from a tree
- **manger** = an open container that horses and cows eat from

- **mass** = to go to church and pray there
- **medieval** = about the Middle Ages
- **mince pie** = a pie that is filled with minced meat; it is eaten by people at Christmas
- **mistletoe** = a plant with small white berries
- **narrow** = not wide
- **nativity scene** = play that tells the story of the birth of Jesus
- **ornament** = an object that makes something look better
- **pagan** = beliefs and customs that do not belong to a main religion
- **pilgrim** = a person who travels to a holy place
- **plum pudding** = pudding or cake with nuts and dried fruit
- **popular** = many people like it
- **procession** = a line of people who walk slowly
- **receive** = get
- **reindeer** = large deer with big horns that live in the northern regions
- **roast** = to cook or grill over a fire
- **rope** = very strong thick string, made by twisting together many thinner strings
- **search** = look for
- **set up** = to put up
- **settler** = someone who goes to a place where not many people have lived before
- **slide** = to move quietly down an object, glide, slip
- **stockings** = long socks
- **supper** = meal that you have early in the evening
- **wise** = intelligent, very sensible
- **wreath** = a circle made from leaves or flowers that a person wears on his/her head



THANKSGIVING

On Thanksgiving Day American people get together with their families and friends to give thanks for the past year. It is **celebrated** with big dinners and special food.

In December, 1620, over 100 **pilgrims** came to America on the Mayflower and landed at Plymouth Rock. The following winter was very **harsh** and they didn't have enough to eat, so more than half of them died. The next year friendly Indians helped them grow corn, **barley** and other **crops**. The **harvest** was good and the **governor** of the colony William Bradford organised a **festival** to thank God for the food that he had given them.

The first Thanksgiving of 1621 lasted for three days. Men shot **ducks**, **geese** and turkeys and caught fish. Ninety Indians came to the **colonists** and **celebrated** with them.

As time went on the **custom** of Thanksgiving spread from Plymouth to other New England colonies, but for many years to come the new country had no national Thanksgiving Day. In 1863 President Abraham Lincoln **formally proclaimed** that Thanksgiving should be **celebrated** on the last Thursday of November.

In 1939 President Franklin D. Roosevelt set the holiday a week earlier. He probably wanted to make the Christmas shopping season a bit longer. Today, the fourth Thursday in November is a holiday all over the United States.

The turkey has become the symbol of Thanksgiving. **Roast** turkey with **cranberry** sauce is one of the most popular meals that Americans have.

Words

- **barley** = a plant that is used for making food and alcohol
- **celebrate** = to have a party and eat and drink
- **colonist** = a person who lives in a colony
- **cranberry** = a small red sour fruit
- **crop** = a plant that you grow to get food
- **custom** = tradition
- **duck** = a water bird with short legs and a wide mouth
- **festival** = special days when people have fun and celebrate
- **formally** = officially
- **goose—geese** = a bird that is like a duck but bigger; it makes loud noises
- **governor** = person who rules a place
- **harsh** = severe, bad
- **harvest** = the time when crops are collected from the fields
- **pilgrim** = a person who travelled to the New World mostly for religious reasons
- **proclaim** = to say publicly
- **roast** = to cook or grill over a fire

HALLOWEEN

Halloween is a festival that takes place every year on October 31. It is a time when children and **adults** dress up in costumes, go **trick or treating** and make **jack-o-lanterns** from empty **pumpkins**.

Halloween goes back to the **customs** and traditions of the **Celts**, who lived between Ireland and Northern France about 2000 years ago. They were **pagans** who did not believe in god. They thought that **witches**, demons and the **spirits** of dead people **wandered** around the world on the evening before November 1. They **lit bonfires** to **scare** them away and they tried to **confuse** these demons by wearing the same clothes that they did. They also **offered** them something to eat.

In **ancient** Rome the festival of Pomona was held in **honour** of the Roman **goddess** of fruits and gardens. At about 800 **A.D.** the Roman Catholic Church **introduced** a new holiday which they called **All Saints' Day**. It was **celebrated** on November 1 and the evening before became known as All Hallows' Eve. Hallow was the old word for "**holy**". Later on All Hallows' Eve was shortened to Halloween. 200 years later **All Souls' Day** became a church holiday. It was day on which people **prayed** for all their dead **relatives**, friends and the people that they had known.

Today Halloween is **celebrated** mainly by children who dress up as ghosts, witches and other **evil spirits**. When they go **trick or treating** from house to house they ask for sweets (a treat) or else they **threaten** to play tricks on the people who don't give them anything. Some children and **adults** go to Halloween parties where they have fun and play games like **bobbing** the apple in a **tub** of water.

In 1950 a school class in a small American neighborhood started collecting money instead of asking for treats. They gave it to the United Nations Children's **Fund** and ever since thousands of children have gone **trick-or treating** for this **cause**.

In many European countries people visit the **graves** of their relatives on **All Saints'** or **All Souls' Day**. At first Halloween was not **celebrated** in Europe as it was in America but during the past few **decades** Halloween parties have become more and more popular in Europe too.

The jack-o'-lantern is **closely connected** with Halloween. It is a **pumpkin** that you empty and **carve** a face into. Most of them have a **candle** or some other light in them.

According to an old Irish story **jack-o'-lanterns** were named after a man called Jack. He could not go to heaven because he was an evil person and often in a **bad mood**. **However**, he couldn't go to hell either because he had tricked the devil many times. So Jack had to stay on Earth **forever** and wander around with his **lantern**.

Words

- **A.D.** = after the birth of Christ
- **according to** = as shown or told by
- **adult** = a grown-up
- **All Saints' Day** = November 1, the day when Christian churches remember all the saints

- **All Souls' Day** = November 2, the day when Christians pray for the souls of those who have died
- **bob** = to move up and down in the water
- **bonfire** = a large outdoor fire
- **candle** = a stick of wax that burns to give you light
- **carve** = to cut into an object
- **cause** = a good idea that you fight for
- **celebrate** = to do something special or enjoy something
- **Celts** = people who lived in Britain and Western Europe two thousand years ago before the Romans came
- **closely** = very much
- **confuse** = mix up
- **custom** = tradition, habit
- **decade** = ten years
- **evil** = bad
- **forever** = without end
- **fund** = an organization that collects money to help people who need it
- **goddess** = a female god
- **grave** = a place in the ground where a dead body is buried
- **holy** = about God and religion, sacred
- **honour** = to show that you admire and think highly of someone
- **jack-o'-lantern** = a pumpkin that you cut a face into and put a candle in
- **lantern** = a lamp that you carry around in a container with glass around it
- **light—lit** = to make a fire
- **mood** = the way you feel
- **offer** = give
- **pagan** = something that does not belong to any religion
- **pray** = to speak to god and thank him or ask him for help
- **pumpkin** = a very large orange fruit that grows on the ground
- **relative** = a member of your family
- **scare** = to make someone feel frightened
- **spirit** = ghost; a creature with no body
- **threaten** = warn, terrorize
- **trick or treat** = to dress up in costumes and go from house to house to ask for sweets
- **tub** = a small container which you put water or another liquid in
- **witch** = a woman who has magic powers and does bad things

EASTER

On Easter Sunday Christians around the world **celebrate** the **Resurrection** of Jesus Christ. The Jewish, religious teacher was the son of God. He was **executed** by the Romans about 2000 years ago. Three days after he had died he returned to life again and **rose** to heaven.

Many Christians think that they will also **rise** to heaven after death. That's why Easter is **celebrated** with joyful music and symbols of new life, like flowers and new clothes.

The name Easter may come from "Eostre", an **Anglo-Saxon goddess**. Every year a spring **festival** was **celebrated** in her **honour**. In most Christian churches Easter is **celebrated** sometime between March 22 and April 25. It falls on the first Sunday after the first full moon in spring.

Easter **marks** the end of a time of prayer and **fasting** that we call **Lent**. **It is believed** that during this time Jesus Christ went through the desert for forty days without food.

The last week before Easter is called Holy Week. It begins on Palm Sunday, the day on which Jesus entered Jerusalem. His **followers** threw palm leaves on the streets. On Holy Thursday, Jesus had his Last **Supper** with his **disciples** or followers. The next day, Good Friday, Jesus was nailed to the **cross**. At 3 o'clock in the afternoon **church services** around the world **recall** the last hours of his **suffering**.

On Easter morning **resurrection** is **celebrated**. On the evening before, many people take part in **processions** with **candles** in the hands. On Easter Day the **fasting** period is over and people get together with their families and friends and have big meals.

Symbols

The lamb is one of the most important symbols of Easter. It comes from the old **Hebrew** Passover, when God ordered the Israelites to **smear** lamb blood on the doors of their houses to **protect** their firstborn sons. Christians also use the lamb as a symbol and called Jesus the Lamb of God.

Another **well-known** symbol of Easter is the egg. It **stands for** life because all life begins in eggs. **Ancient** Persians and Egyptians saw eggs as a sign of spring and coloured and ate them.

In North America and in some European countries children **enjoy searching for** Easter eggs that are hidden by the Easter **bunny**. On Easter Monday egg rolling has become a traditional **event** on the **lawn** of the White House in Washington D.C.

Words

- **Anglo-Saxon** = people who lived in England starting at about 600 A.D.
- **bunny** = children's word for rabbit
- **candle** = a stick of wax that burns and gives light
- **celebrate** = to do something special on an important day
- **church service** = mass or other events in church
- **cross** = the object that Jesus died on
- **disciple** = one of the twelve men that were Christ's followers

- **event** = a very interesting thing that happens
- **execute** = to kill
- **fasting** = when you eat little or no food
- **festival** = special days when people have fun and celebrate
- **follower** = someone who believes in a leader
- **goddess** = a female god
- **Hebrew** = the Jews who lived in ancient times
- **honour** = to show how much the people liked her
- **it is believed** = people think that
- **lawn** = grass, garden
- **Lent** = the forty days before Easter
- **mark** = to be sign of
- **procession** = a line of people who walk slowly
- **protect** = defend, guard
- **rise—rose** = to go up
- **recall** = remember
- **resurrection** = the return to life of Jesus after he was nailed to the cross
- **smear** = to spread a liquid over a surface especially in a careless way
- **stand for** = a symbol of
- **suffering** = to have pain
- **supper** = meal that you have early in the evening



PASSOVER

Passover is the Jewish **feast** of **freedom**. It is **celebrated** at about the same time as Easter and lasts for 7 or 8 days. During Passover **Jews** around the world remember their **freedom** from **slavery** in Egypt.

In **ancient** times Egypt was one of the most powerful countries in the worlds. It **conquered** smaller nations and made their people **slaves**. The early **Jews**, or Hebrews as they were called, also became Egyptian **slaves**. The **Pharaoh forced** them to work hard. They had to **put up** buildings and pull heavy stones across the desert. He gave them little food to eat and no **freedom**.

The Bible tells us that God **chose** Moses to lead the **Jews** out of Egypt and to the land of Canaan, which is today's Israel. Moses went to the Pharaoh and asked him to let the Jews free. When the king said no God sent down ten **plagues**, or **punishments** to **force** the king to **change his mind**.

The word Passover comes from the tenth **plague**. The firstborn son of every Egyptian family was killed. God told the Jews to **mark** their door posts with the blood of a **roasted** lamb to show him that they were his children. In this way the firstborn sons of the Jews **survived**.

When the Pharaoh's son died he told Moses to lead the Hebrews out of Egypt. When they **reached** the Red Sea they heard Egyptian armies coming after them. Moses **raised** his **staff** over the water and the sea **split** open so that the Hebrews could go across. Then the sea closed up again and the Pharaoh's army **drowned**. Moses and his people wandered around for forty years before they found the **Promised Land**. Moses, however, died and never **reached** it.

Today, many Jews gather in **synagogues** every year to retell the Passover story. The most important food of this holiday is "matzo", which is bread made of **flour** and water. It is flat because Moses and his followers didn't have time to let the bread **rise**. Many families sing songs and say **prayers** during the holidays.

Words

- **change your mind** = to have a different opinion from the one you had first
- **choose, chose** = to decide who you want to have
- **conquer** = to take control of a country by fighting
- **drown** = to die when you are under water for a long time
- **feast** = a time when people do a lot of things they like
- **flour** = a powder that you make by crushing wheat or other another crop; you use it to make bread or cake
- **force** = to make someone do something
- **freedom** = liberty
- **Jew** = a person whose religion is Judaism
- **mark** = to make a sign
- **plague** = disease

- **prayer** = words that you say to God
- **Promised Land** = the land that was promised to the Hebrews by God
- **punishment** = penalty, something you have to do if you have done something wrong
- **put up** = build, construct
- **raise** = to lift something or move higher
- **rise** = go up
- **reach** = get to
- **roast** = cook or grill on a fire
- **slave** = a person who is not free and belongs to someone else
- **split** = to break apart
- **staff** = a long walking stick
- **survive** = to live on after a dangerous situation
- **synagogue** = a building where Jewish people meet to pray



CHINESE NEW YEAR

Chinese New Year is the most important holiday of the Chinese calendar. The New Year begins between January 21 and February 20. The **celebration** starts with the second new moon after the beginning of winter (December 21) and lasts until the next full moon.

The Chinese name their years after 12 different animals: the rat, the ox, the tiger, the **hare**, the **dragon**, the snake, the horse, the sheep, the monkey, the **rooster**, the dog, the pig. Some people believe that a **human being's personality** and character **depends** on the animal of the year he or she was born.

The Chinese New Year **marks** the start of the next animal's year. After the year of the pig the twelve year **cycle** starts over again with the year of the rat.

A lot of things are done for Chinese New Year. Houses are cleaned from top to bottom in the days before the beginning of the holidays. People write **merry** wishes on red paper and hang them all over the house. Rooms are **decorated** with flowers, plants and oranges.

On New Year's Eve **firecrackers** send out the old year and welcome the new one. At midnight people open all their doors and windows to let the old year out. On New Year's Day children and **adults** who are not married get red **envelopes** with money in them. This is a symbol of good look and **wealth** in the new year.

Food plays an important part in Chinese New Year **celebrations**. Special **dishes** are eaten on certain days. Many kinds of food have special meanings. **Uncut noodles**, for example, might give you a longer life. People who eat a lot of **raw** fish are said to be more successful in life.

The last event of the 15-day celebration is the Lantern Festival. Some people hang **glowing lanterns** in **temples**. Others carry **lanterns** in a moonlight parade. In many places long colourful dragons made out of **silk**, paper and **bamboo** are carried on the streets by dancers.

Words

- **admire** = to respect and think highly of
- **bamboo** = a tropical plant that is empty inside; it is used to make furniture
- **celebration** = event of celebrating, having a party
- **cycle** = a series of events that happen again and again, mostly in the same order
- **decorate** = to make something look more beautiful by putting nice things on it
- **depend on** = here: something affects something else
- **dish** = meal
- **dragon** = a large animal that has wings and can breathe out fire
- **envelope** = a thin paper in which you put and send a letter
- **firecracker** = a small firework that explodes loudly
- **glow** = to produce or reflect light
- **hare** = rabbit
- **human being** = a person

- **lantern** = a lamp that has a light inside it
- **mark** = is the sign for
- **merry** = happy, cheerful
- **noodles** = long pieces of thin food made from flour water and eggs , like spaghetti
- **personality** = someone's character; the way they behave towards others
- **raw** = not cooked
- **rooster** = a male chicken
- **silk** = a smooth soft cloth made from a material that is produced by a silkworm
- **temple** = a place where people go to pray to God
- **uncut** = not cut
- **wealth** = a lot of money; being rich



ITALIAN CITY BANS FOREIGN FOOD

Until a short time ago, Italians mostly ate Italian food, but in the past **decade** more and more **immigrants** have been coming into the country and with them their food. Now Italians are fighting back.

The **Tuscan** town of Lucca does not want any kebab shops and Chinese restaurants in their historic city any more. Lucca, about 60 km from Florence, has **declared** that it wants to **preserve** its food tradition. **Therefore**, no more **foreign** food shops are allowed.

A debate is going on between town leaders and the population. Is it possible to **forbid** other cultures in our era of globalization?

Italy's **agriculture** minister **supports** the **ban**. He says that it is important to **preserve** Italian culture and tradition.

Others are **ashamed** of what has happened. Critics of the new **law** say that a lot of typically Italian food does not **originate** in Italy but comes from other regions: tomatoes from South America or pasta from China.

The **issue** is also **influenced** by the **politicians** of the region. In northern Italy the right wing Northern League is very strong. It is against **foreigners** and **foreign** culture in Italy.

Italians are also afraid that products from other countries are being sold as Italian. Cheap restaurants buy low quality olive oil from Greece or Turkey. **Truffles** that are imported from China are often **passed on** as Italian **truffles** from the northern part of the country.

On the other side the agriculture minister has told his fellow citizens that they should not eat their loved pineapples, but instead turn to panetone, a type of sponge cake.

Words

- **ashamed of** = to feel bad because you have done something
- **ban** = here: the new law
- **forbid** = not to allow
- **foreign** = from another country
- **immigrant** = a person who comes from another country and wants to live or work in a new country
- **influence** = to affect the way something develops or the way someone thinks or feels
- **issue** = topic
- **law** = the rules of a country
- **originate** = come from
- **pass on as** = to be seen as
- **politician** = person who has a political job in the government or in parliament
- **support** = to be for something
- **therefore** = that is why
- **truffle** = like a mushroom that grows under the ground; it is very expensive
- **Tuscany** = area of northern Italy famous for wine and beautiful old cities

BULLFIGHTING – A BIG ATTRACTION IN SPAIN

Bullfighting is a great event that **attracts** many tourists to Spain and Spanish speaking countries. There it is an important element of culture and has a great tradition. Modern bullfighting goes back to the 1700s when the first bullrings were built in Spain.

A bullfight takes place in bullring. The matador, or bullfighter, has special training and is often a national hero in his homeland. The bulls used for bullfighting are very powerful, wild animals that are **bred** to attack. They **weigh** up to 500 kg or even more. Today many animal activists are against bullfighting because bulls are treated in a **cruel** way and have to **suffer** pain in the arena. Bullfights can also end with a matador's death or **injury** if he is **pierced** by a bull's horns.

A bullfight usually **consists** of six fights. Three matadors with their teams fight two bulls each. A bullfight has three acts. After the trumpets sound at the beginning, the bull is let into the ring. The bullfighter waves a colorful **cape** at the bull and tries to make it **attack**. During this part he studies the **movements** of the bull. A **picador** enters the arena on horseback. He makes the bull weaker by **piercing** his neck with sharp **spikes**.

In the second act, the assistants of the matador, called banderilleros, come into the ring on foot, run around and throw **barbed** darts into the animal's neck to make it even **madder**. In the final act the bullfighter is in the ring alone with the bull. He uses a small cape, waves at the bull and **lures** it into attacking him. He tries to be as **close** to the bull as possible. Finally, he **thrusts** his **sword** into the bull's neck and kills it. If he **succeeds** in pushing the sword into the bull's **shoulder blades** it dies at once. After the successful **performance** of the matador the **spectators** get up and applaud. The bullfighter gets one or maybe even two of the bull's ears as a **reward**.

Words

- **attract** = to pull towards; bring to
- **barbed** = with one or more curved points
- **breed** – **bred** = to bring animals together so that they can have babies that are very good or strong
- **cape** = a piece of cloth that a bullfighter waves
- **lure** = to make someone do something you want
- **madder** = angrier
- **picador** = man in a bullfight who rides a horse and weakens a bull by throwing small spears into it
- **pierce** = to make a small hole into something with a sharp object
- **shoulder blade** = one of the two flat bones on each side of your back
- **spectator** = a person who watches a fight
- **spike** = sharp, metal points
- **suffer** = undergo
- **sword** = a weapon with a long pointed blade
- **thrust** = push, force